CS 700 Midterm Notes Mon 10/26, open book and notes, no electronics

1. Metrics (Lecture 2)

Good metrics are linear, reliable, repeatable, easy to use, consistent and independent. Reliable, repeatable, consistent and independent are required. Linear and easy to use are nice but not necessary.

MIPS $= \dfrac{n}{T_e \times 10^6}$, MFLOPS $= \dfrac{f}{T_e \times 10^6}$. MIPS fails reliable and consistent (CISC vs RISC, CPI). MFLOPS gives an integer program 0 and a FLOP isn't defined the same everywhere. SPEC normalizes to a basis machine and takes a geometric mean, which is the wrong mean for times.

Means metrics (clock rate, MIPS, MFLOPS) count what was done. Ends metrics (execution time) count what got accomplished. Execution time is the fundamental metric. Report wall clock and CPU time.

Speedup of system 2 over 1 is $S_{2,1} = \dfrac{T_1}{T_2} = \dfrac{R_2}{R_1}$. Relative change is $\Delta_{2,1} = \dfrac{T_1 - T_2}{T_2} = S_{2,1} - 1$. Precision $= \dfrac{\text{relevant retrieved}}{\text{retrieved}}$, recall $= \dfrac{\text{relevant retrieved}}{\text{all relevant}}$.

2. Summarizing data (Lecture 4)

Center

Mean $\bar{x} = \frac{1}{n}\sum x_i$, median is the middle sorted value (average the two middle ones when n is even), mode is the most frequent value or bin. Use the median when the data is skewed or has outliers, the mode for categorical data, and the mean when the total matters.

Harmonic $\bar{x}_H = \dfrac{n}{\sum 1/x_i}$ for rates whose numerator (work) is fixed.

Geometric $\bar{x}_G = \left(\prod x_i\right)^{1/n}$ for ratios that compound or normalized values. Arithmetic for times, sizes and anything whose sum means something.

The mean of a rate should track total work over total time. If every program does the same work F, then the right average rate is $\dfrac{nF}{\sum t_i}$, which is the harmonic mean of the rates.

Weighted forms, with $\sum w_i = 1$, $\bar{x}_A = \sum w_i x_i$, $\bar{x}_H = 1/\sum \frac{w_i}{x_i}$, $\bar{x}_G = \prod x_i^{w_i}$. Always $\bar{x}_H \le \bar{x}_G \le \bar{x}_A$, equal only when all values are equal.

Spread

Range $= x_{\max} - x_{\min}$. Sample variance $s^2 = \dfrac{\sum (x_i - \bar{x})^2}{n-1} = \dfrac{\sum x_i^2 - n\bar{x}^2}{n-1}$. Standard deviation s. Coefficient of variation COV $= s/\bar{x}$ (unitless). IQR $= Q_3 - Q_1$, SIQR $= \dfrac{Q_3 - Q_1}{2}$. Midhinge $= \dfrac{Q_1 + Q_3}{2}$. Use s with the mean, SIQR or IQR with the median.

Quantiles, course convention

Sort $x_{(1)} \le \cdots \le x_{(n)}$ and give $x_{(i)}$ the plotting position $f_i = \dfrac{i - 0.5}{n}$. For a quantile q, find i with $f_i \le q \le f_{i+1}$ and interpolate linearly between $x_{(i)}$ and $x_{(i+1)}$. Histogram bins by Sturges, $k = \lfloor 1 + \log_2 n \rfloor$ on the slide (HW3 rounded instead, so say which you used). Excel's PERCENTILE on the slides interpolates at $1 + (n-1)p$, which gives slightly different quartiles.

Normal Q-Q plot

Plot $\left(z_i,\ x_{(i)}\right)$ with $z_i = \Phi^{-1}(f_i)$, or rescale to $m + s\,z_i$ so both axes share units. A straight line means normal. Ends bending away from the line mean heavy tails, and a curve bending one way means skew.

3. Confidence intervals (Lecture 6)

Mean

Large n (slides say $n > 30$) $\quad \bar{x} \mp z_{\alpha/2}\dfrac{s}{\sqrt{n}}$.

Small n, normal population $\quad \bar{x} \mp t_{[\alpha/2,\,n-1]}\dfrac{s}{\sqrt{n}}$.

All decks use upper-tail notation, $z_{\alpha/2}$ or $z[\alpha/2]$ is the value with area $\alpha/2$ above it, which the CI deck also calls the $(1-\alpha/2)$-quantile. Same number, e.g. 1.96 for 95%. The p.50 table labels them $z_{0.95}$, $z_{0.975}$. For $n = 15$ use df 14, $t = 2.145$.

Common levels $\quad 90\% \to 1.645$, $95\% \to 1.960$, $99\% \to 2.576$.

Batch means split a correlated series into batches and treat batch means as the sample. A 95% CI means 95% of intervals built this way cover μ. It does not mean μ has a 95% chance of being in this particular interval, and it says nothing about 95% of the data. The width shrinks like $1/\sqrt{n}$, so halving it takes four times as many runs.

How many measurements

For a half-width of e as a fraction of the mean, $n = \left(\dfrac{z_{\alpha/2}\,s}{e\,\bar{x}}\right)^2$, rounded up. Slide example $s = 2.14$, $\bar{x} = 7.94$, 90%, $e = 0.035$ gives $n = 160.5 \to 161$. The slide's "within 7%" is the full width, so the half-width is 3.5%.

Proportion

$p = m/n$, $\quad p \mp z_{\alpha/2}\sqrt{\dfrac{p(1-p)}{n}}$, valid when $np \ge 10$ (slide) and $n(1-p) \ge 10$ (study guide). Wald interval, poor for small n. Sample size with e as a RELATIVE error (slides) $n = \dfrac{z_{\alpha/2}^2\,p(1-p)}{(e\,p)^2}$. Slide example $e = 0.005$, $p = 0.1097$ gives 1.25 million 10 ms samples, 3.46 hours. With an absolute half-width e (measurement study guide) drop the p in the denominator. Slide example $m = 658$ of $n = 6000$, so $p = 0.1097$ and the 95% CI is 10.2% to 11.8%.

Variance (normal data only)

$\left(\dfrac{(n-1)s^2}{\chi^2_{1-\alpha/2,\,n-1}},\ \dfrac{(n-1)s^2}{\chi^2_{\alpha/2,\,n-1}}\right)$. The larger χ^2 quantile goes in the left denominator.

4. Hypothesis testing (Lecture 9)

Steps state H_0 and H_1, choose α and one or two sides BEFORE the data, compute the statistic, compare with the critical value or find p, then report the effect with an interval.

$Z = \dfrac{\bar{x} - \mu_0}{\sigma/\sqrt{n}}$, $\quad t = \dfrac{\bar{x} - \mu_0}{s/\sqrt{n}}$ with $n-1$ df. Two-sided, reject if $|Z| > z[\alpha/2]$. One-sided, reject if $Z > z[\alpha]$. A two-sided test at α rejects exactly when the $(1-\alpha)$ CI excludes μ_0.

p is the probability of a statistic at least this extreme IF H_0 is true. It's not the probability that H_0 is true.

	H_0 true	H_0 false
Reject	Type I (α)	correct (power $1-\beta$)
Don't reject	correct	Type II (β)

Runs needed to detect a difference δ $\quad n = \left(\dfrac{(z[\alpha/2] + z[\beta])\,\sigma}{\delta}\right)^2$. At $\alpha = 0.05$ and power 0.80, $(1.96 + 0.84)^2 \approx 7.8$, so $n \approx 7.8\,\sigma^2/\delta^2$.

Not rejecting is not proof of no difference. With m tests at α each, expect about $m\alpha$ false positives, and Bonferroni uses α/m per test. Holm sorts the p values and compares the k-th smallest with $\alpha/(m-k+1)$, stopping at the first failure. Benjamini-Hochberg compares the k-th smallest with $k\alpha/m$ and controls the false discovery rate. Correlated samples count for less, e.g. 400 samples with $n_{\text{eff}} = 100$ halve Z. Statistical significance says nothing about whether the effect matters, so give the effect size and its CI.

5. Comparing two alternatives (Lecture 10)

Pick the test

1. Same unit (workload, benchmark) under both? Yes means paired, no means unpaired.
2. Paired with roughly normal differences, paired t on the differences.
3. Paired with outliers, Wilcoxon signed-rank if symmetric, sign test or bootstrap if skewed.
4. Unpaired and roughly normal, Welch's t.
5. Unpaired and skewed or ordinal, Mann-Whitney U or bootstrap.

For paired tests, normality is about the differences, not A or B.

Paired

$d_i = a_i - b_i, \quad \bar{d} \mp t[\alpha/2,\, n-1]\,\dfrac{s_d}{\sqrt{n}}, \quad n$ is the number of PAIRS.

Pairing removes the shared variation $2\rho\sigma_A\sigma_B$ from the variance of the difference, so it helps whenever $\rho > 0$.

Unpaired, Welch

$$s = \sqrt{\frac{s_A^2}{n_A} + \frac{s_B^2}{n_B}}, \quad (\bar{x}_A - \bar{x}_B) \mp t[\alpha/2,\, \nu]\, s,$$

$$\nu = \frac{\left(\frac{s_A^2}{n_A} + \frac{s_B^2}{n_B}\right)^2}{\frac{(s_A^2/n_A)^2}{n_A - 1} + \frac{(s_B^2/n_B)^2}{n_B - 1}}$$

Use ν as is or round DOWN (more conservative). It lies between $\min(n_A, n_B) - 1$ and $n_A + n_B - 2$. Pooled t assumes equal variances and uses $n_A + n_B - 2$ df. Welch is the default.

Reading results

If the CI for the difference contains 0, you can't say they differ at that level. Overlapping single-system CIs do NOT mean no difference (HW6 Miller example), and checking overlap is not a test. Runs needed paired $n = \big((z[\alpha/2] + z[\beta])\, s_d/\delta\big)^2$, unpaired per group $n = 2\big((z[\alpha/2] + z[\beta])\, s/\delta\big)^2$.

6. Measurement (Lecture 11)

A CI describes sampling error and nothing else. Repetition shrinks random error but never systematic error such as bias, a wrong clock or perturbation. Strategies event counting gives exact totals with tiny overhead but no context, tracing gives full detail and order but the most perturbation and data, sampling sets the overhead you choose but is statistical and misses rare events. Exactness, context and low overhead, you get two. Report the clock and its resolution. Finer observation means more perturbation. Timer rollover after $(2^n - 1)\, T_c$ for an n-bit counter with tick T_c. A single reading is off by up to one tick, so time k repetitions and divide, $(T_k - T_{\text{loop}})/k$. Overhead share of a measurement is about $2c/(T + 2c)$ for read cost c.

7. Plagiarism and authorship (full research topics in Part 2)

Plagiarism per Luke's TR includes copied text without quotes even when cited, close paraphrase, reused figures, and self-plagiarism of your own published text. Cite ideas, quote words. Authorship goes to people who made an intellectual contribution.

8. More formulas from the handouts and study guides

Metrics

$T_e = \dfrac{n \times \text{CPI}}{f_{\text{clock}}}$ (not on the slides). GFLOPS and TFLOPS divide by 10^9 and 10^{12}. Jain's fairness $J = \dfrac{(\sum x_i)^2}{n \sum x_i^2}$ (HW2 only).

Summarizing

Quantile q sits at position $r = nq + 0.5$ in the sorted data, interpolate between $x_{(\lfloor r \rfloor)}$ and the next value. Tukey fences $Q_1 - 1.5\,\text{IQR}$ and $Q_3 + 1.5\,\text{IQR}$, beyond them is an outlier. Work-weighted harmonic mean uses $w_i = F_i / \sum F_j$. Inverse CDFs for Q-Q plots, $u = f_i$ exponential with mean a, $-a \ln(1-u)$ (rate $\lambda = 1/a$) Pareto, $k(1-u)^{-1/a}$ geometric, $\lceil \ln(1-u)/\ln(1-p) \rceil$ (Summ p.64 writes $\ln u$, which is the random-variate form) normal, $z \approx 4.91\,[q^{0.14} - (1-q)^{0.14}]$, then $m + s\,z$. Feitelson puts the data on the x-axis, Setia and HW3 on the y-axis, so slope rules read reversed. $\ln 0.9 = -0.1054$, $\ln 0.7 = -0.3567$, $\ln 0.5 = -0.6931$, $\ln 0.3 = -1.2040$, $\ln 0.1 = -2.3026$.

Confidence intervals

Batch means with m batches $\bar{b} \mp t[\alpha/2,\, m-1]\, s_b/\sqrt{m}$. Sample size scales as $n_2 = n_1 (h_1/h_2)^2$ for half-widths h. Proportion size with ABSOLUTE error e $n = z_{\alpha/2}^2\, p(1-p)/e^2$, use $p = 0.5$ with no pilot (95%, $e = 0.03$ gives 1068). Log transform build the CI on $\ln x$, then (e^L, e^U) is an interval for the median, centred on the geometric mean. Bootstrap percentile 95% CI is the 2.5th and 97.5th percentiles of the B resampled statistics. Monte Carlo $\bar{Y}(n) = (b-a)\frac{1}{n}\sum g(X_i)$, $\text{Var} = \text{Var}(Y)/n$.

Hypothesis testing

Two proportions $Z = \dfrac{\hat{p}_1 - \hat{p}_2}{\sqrt{\hat{p}(1-\hat{p})(1/n_1 + 1/n_2)}}$, pooled $\hat{p} = \dfrac{m_1 + m_2}{n_1 + n_2}$. McNemar (paired yes/no) $Z = \dfrac{b - c}{\sqrt{b + c}}$, only the disagreements b and c count. Paired $t = \bar{d}/(s_d/\sqrt{n})$. Power $\approx P\big[Z > z[\alpha/2] - |\delta|\sqrt{n}/\sigma\big]$. Family-wise error $1 - (1-\alpha)^m$, e.g. 23% at $m = 5$, 92% at $m = 50$. Simultaneous intervals use $z[\alpha/(2m)]$. Correlated samples $n_{\text{eff}} = n\dfrac{1-\rho}{1+\rho}$. Pocock cutoffs for peeking 2.18 (2 looks), 2.41 (5 looks). Chi-square goodness of fit $\sum (O-E)^2/E$ with $k - m$ df (m includes the 1 for the total plus fitted parameters).

Comparing alternatives

Pooled $s_p^2 = \dfrac{(n_A - 1)s_A^2 + (n_B - 1)s_B^2}{n_A + n_B - 2}$, Cohen's $d = (\bar{x}_A - \bar{x}_B)/s_p$, paired $d_z = \bar{d}/s_d$. Signed-rank, large n $\mu_W = n(n+1)/4$, $\sigma_W^2 = n(n+1)(2n+1)/24$. Sign test $S \sim \text{Bin}(n, \frac{1}{2})$, $z = (S - n/2)/(\sqrt{n}/2)$. Mann-Whitney $U_1 = W_1 - n_1(n_1+1)/2$, $\mu_U = n_1 n_2/2$, $\sigma_U^2 = n_1 n_2 (n_1 + n_2 + 1)/12$, $A_{12} = U_1/(n_1 n_2)$. All pairs of c systems $1 - (1-\alpha)^{c(c-1)/2}$ chance of a false positive.

Measurement

Wrapped counter ticks = end + 2^n − start. Instrumentation overhead $(T_{\text{inst}} - T_{\text{base}})/T_{\text{base}}$. Ratio error $(\sigma_R/R)^2 \approx (\sigma_A/A)^2 + (\sigma_B/B)^2$. Unpaired SE of a difference $\sqrt{SE_A^2 + SE_B^2}$. Nested runs, p processes with k iterations each $\text{Var}(\bar{x}) = \sigma_p^2/p + \sigma_i^2/(pk)$, cost $c_p p + c_i pk \le B$. Extra processes beat extra iterations.

Student t critical values, upper-tail area

$t[\alpha/2,\, \nu]$ for a two-sided $(1-\alpha)$ CI, e.g. 95% uses the .025 column, 90% uses .05.

df	.10	.05	.025	.01	.005
1	3.078	6.314	12.706	31.821	63.657
2	1.886	2.920	4.303	6.965	9.925
3	1.638	2.353	3.182	4.541	5.841
4	1.533	2.132	2.776	3.747	4.604
5	1.476	2.015	2.571	3.365	4.032
6	1.440	1.943	2.447	3.143	3.707
7	1.415	1.895	2.365	2.998	3.499
8	1.397	1.860	2.306	2.896	3.355
9	1.383	1.833	2.262	2.821	3.250
10	1.372	1.812	2.228	2.764	3.169
11	1.363	1.796	2.201	2.718	3.106
12	1.356	1.782	2.179	2.681	3.055
13	1.350	1.771	2.160	2.650	3.012
14	1.345	1.761	2.145	2.624	2.977
15	1.341	1.753	2.131	2.602	2.947
16	1.337	1.746	2.120	2.583	2.921
17	1.333	1.740	2.110	2.567	2.898
18	1.330	1.734	2.101	2.552	2.878
19	1.328	1.729	2.093	2.539	2.861
20	1.325	1.725	2.086	2.528	2.845
21	1.323	1.721	2.080	2.518	2.831
22	1.321	1.717	2.074	2.508	2.819
23	1.319	1.714	2.069	2.500	2.807
24	1.318	1.711	2.064	2.492	2.797
25	1.316	1.708	2.060	2.485	2.787
26	1.315	1.706	2.056	2.479	2.779
27	1.314	1.703	2.052	2.473	2.771
28	1.313	1.701	2.048	2.467	2.763
29	1.311	1.699	2.045	2.462	2.756
30	1.310	1.697	2.042	2.457	2.750
35	1.306	1.690	2.030	2.438	2.724
40	1.303	1.684	2.021	2.423	2.704
50	1.299	1.676	2.009	2.403	2.678
60	1.296	1.671	2.000	2.390	2.660
80	1.292	1.664	1.990	2.374	2.639
100	1.290	1.660	1.984	2.364	2.626
120	1.289	1.658	1.980	2.358	2.617
∞	1.282	1.645	1.960	2.326	2.576

Square roots

2	1.414	27	5.196	52	7.211	77	8.775
3	1.732	28	5.292	53	7.280	78	8.832
4	2.000	29	5.385	54	7.348	79	8.888
5	2.236	30	5.477	55	7.416	80	8.944
6	2.449	31	5.568	56	7.483	81	9.000
7	2.646	32	5.657	57	7.550	82	9.055
8	2.828	33	5.745	58	7.616	83	9.110
9	3.000	34	5.831	59	7.681	84	9.165
10	3.162	35	5.916	60	7.746	85	9.220
11	3.317	36	6.000	61	7.810	86	9.274
12	3.464	37	6.083	62	7.874	87	9.327
13	3.606	38	6.164	63	7.937	88	9.381
14	3.742	39	6.245	64	8.000	89	9.434
15	3.873	40	6.325	65	8.062	90	9.487
16	4.000	41	6.403	66	8.124	91	9.539
17	4.123	42	6.481	67	8.185	92	9.592
18	4.243	43	6.557	68	8.246	93	9.644
19	4.359	44	6.633	69	8.307	94	9.695
20	4.472	45	6.708	70	8.367	95	9.747
21	4.583	46	6.782	71	8.426	96	9.798
22	4.690	47	6.856	72	8.485	97	9.849
23	4.796	48	6.928	73	8.544	98	9.899
24	4.899	49	7.000	74	8.602	99	9.950
25	5.000	50	7.071	75	8.660	100	10.000
26	5.099	51	7.141	76	8.718		

Standard normal $\Phi(z) = P(Z \le z)$

$P(Z > z) = 1-\Phi(z)$ and $\Phi(-z) = 1-\Phi(z)$. Critical values $z[.05] = 1.645$, $z[.025] = 1.960$, $z[.01] = 2.326$, $z[.005] = 2.576$, $z[.20] = 0.842$.

z	.00	.01	.02	.03	.04	.05	.06	.07	.08	.09
0.0	.5000	.5040	.5080	.5120	.5160	.5199	.5239	.5279	.5319	.5359
0.1	.5398	.5438	.5478	.5517	.5557	.5596	.5636	.5675	.5714	.5753
0.2	.5793	.5832	.5871	.5910	.5948	.5987	.6026	.6064	.6103	.6141
0.3	.6179	.6217	.6255	.6293	.6331	.6368	.6406	.6443	.6480	.6517
0.4	.6554	.6591	.6628	.6664	.6700	.6736	.6772	.6808	.6844	.6879
0.5	.6915	.6950	.6985	.7019	.7054	.7088	.7123	.7157	.7190	.7224
0.6	.7257	.7291	.7324	.7357	.7389	.7422	.7454	.7486	.7517	.7549
0.7	.7580	.7611	.7642	.7673	.7704	.7734	.7764	.7794	.7823	.7852
0.8	.7881	.7910	.7939	.7967	.7995	.8023	.8051	.8078	.8106	.8133
0.9	.8159	.8186	.8212	.8238	.8264	.8289	.8315	.8340	.8365	.8389
1.0	.8413	.8438	.8461	.8485	.8508	.8531	.8554	.8577	.8599	.8621
1.1	.8643	.8665	.8686	.8708	.8729	.8749	.8770	.8790	.8810	.8830
1.2	.8849	.8869	.8888	.8907	.8925	.8944	.8962	.8980	.8997	.9015
1.3	.9032	.9049	.9066	.9082	.9099	.9115	.9131	.9147	.9162	.9177
1.4	.9192	.9207	.9222	.9236	.9251	.9265	.9279	.9292	.9306	.9319
1.5	.9332	.9345	.9357	.9370	.9382	.9394	.9406	.9418	.9429	.9441
1.6	.9452	.9463	.9474	.9484	.9495	.9505	.9515	.9525	.9535	.9545
1.7	.9554	.9564	.9573	.9582	.9591	.9599	.9608	.9616	.9625	.9633
1.8	.9641	.9649	.9656	.9664	.9671	.9678	.9686	.9693	.9699	.9706
1.9	.9713	.9719	.9726	.9732	.9738	.9744	.9750	.9756	.9761	.9767
2.0	.9772	.9778	.9783	.9788	.9793	.9798	.9803	.9808	.9812	.9817
2.1	.9821	.9826	.9830	.9834	.9838	.9842	.9846	.9850	.9854	.9857
2.2	.9861	.9864	.9868	.9871	.9875	.9878	.9881	.9884	.9887	.9890
2.3	.9893	.9896	.9898	.9901	.9904	.9906	.9909	.9911	.9913	.9916
2.4	.9918	.9920	.9922	.9925	.9927	.9929	.9931	.9932	.9934	.9936
2.5	.9938	.9940	.9941	.9943	.9945	.9946	.9948	.9949	.9951	.9952
2.6	.9953	.9955	.9956	.9957	.9959	.9960	.9961	.9962	.9963	.9964
2.7	.9965	.9966	.9967	.9968	.9969	.9970	.9971	.9972	.9973	.9974
2.8	.9974	.9975	.9976	.9977	.9977	.9978	.9979	.9979	.9980	.9981
2.9	.9981	.9982	.9982	.9983	.9984	.9984	.9985	.9985	.9986	.9986
3.0	.9987	.9987	.9987	.9988	.9988	.9989	.9989	.9989	.9990	.9990
3.1	.9990	.9991	.9991	.9991	.9992	.9992	.9992	.9992	.9993	.9993
3.2	.9993	.9993	.9994	.9994	.9994	.9994	.9994	.9995	.9995	.9995
3.3	.9995	.9995	.9995	.9996	.9996	.9996	.9996	.9996	.9996	.9997
3.4	.9997	.9997	.9997	.9997	.9997	.9997	.9997	.9997	.9997	.9998

χ^2 quantiles, $P(\chi^2_\nu \le x)$

df	0.005	0.025	0.05	0.95	0.975	0.995
1	0.00	0.00	0.00	3.84	5.02	7.88
2	0.01	0.05	0.10	5.99	7.38	10.60
3	0.07	0.22	0.35	7.81	9.35	12.84
4	0.21	0.48	0.71	9.49	11.14	14.86
5	0.41	0.83	1.15	11.07	12.83	16.75
6	0.68	1.24	1.64	12.59	14.45	18.55
7	0.99	1.69	2.17	14.07	16.01	20.28
8	1.34	2.18	2.73	15.51	17.53	21.95
9	1.73	2.70	3.33	16.92	19.02	23.59
10	2.16	3.25	3.94	18.31	20.48	25.19
11	2.60	3.82	4.57	19.68	21.92	26.76
12	3.07	4.40	5.23	21.03	23.34	28.30
13	3.57	5.01	5.89	22.36	24.74	29.82
14	4.07	5.63	6.57	23.68	26.12	31.32
15	4.60	6.26	7.26	25.00	27.49	32.80
16	5.14	6.91	7.96	26.30	28.85	34.27
17	5.70	7.56	8.67	27.59	30.19	35.72
18	6.26	8.23	9.39	28.87	31.53	37.16
19	6.84	8.91	10.12	30.14	32.85	38.58
20	7.43	9.59	10.85	31.41	34.17	40.00
21	8.03	10.28	11.59	32.67	35.48	41.40
22	8.64	10.98	12.34	33.92	36.78	42.80
23	9.26	11.69	13.09	35.17	38.08	44.18
24	9.89	12.40	13.85	36.42	39.36	45.56
25	10.52	13.12	14.61	37.65	40.65	46.93
26	11.16	13.84	15.38	38.89	41.92	48.29
27	11.81	14.57	16.15	40.11	43.19	49.64
28	12.46	15.31	16.93	41.34	44.46	50.99
29	13.12	16.05	17.71	42.56	45.72	52.34
30	13.79	16.79	18.49	43.77	46.98	53.67
40	20.71	24.43	26.51	55.76	59.34	66.77
50	27.99	32.36	34.76	67.50	71.42	79.49
60	35.53	40.48	43.19	79.08	83.30	91.95

Advisors, CS 701, publishing and ethics

These four lectures have no math and no homework. Expect true/false, "is this acceptable and why", classify-the-misconduct and one h-index calculation. Every fact below has a cite like (CS701 p.4), which is the PDF page of that deck. Luke's plagiarism tech report GMU-CS-TR-2013-8 is cited as (Luke TR p.N). A myth-vs-truth table for all four decks is at the end.

0. Why these lectures are in CS 700 (Intro deck)

The big idea

CS 700 used to be only the "systems" course on experimental methods and statistics. In 2018 the PhD program was restructured to cut time to completion, so the course now also teaches how research works and helps match you with a faculty member for CS 701 (Intro p.2, p.3). That's why advisor, publishing and ethics lectures sit next to confidence intervals.

Facts

- CS 700 is the required "systems" counterpart to the required theory courses CS 583 and CS 600. Its subject is experimental methods and quantitative techniques in CS (Intro p.2).
- Course topics are an overview of the research process (meeting CS faculty, matching for CS 701) plus the "old CS 700" of measurement, simulation and statistical methods (Intro p.3).
- PhD-process topics are what a PhD is and why get one, finding an advisor and working well with one, picking a dissertation topic, finding a job (academia vs industry), research ethics and integrity, how and when to use AI, and tools like LaTeX, plotting and scripting. Reading papers, reviewing papers and giving talks are left to the advanced seminar courses, CS 800 (Intro p.4).
- Early weeks use the second half of class to discuss one of these topics, with pointers to CRA workshop talks. Faculty research talks run through the semester to help you find a 701 match. Guest lectures at the end cover experimental techniques in areas like software engineering and ML (Intro p.5).
- Scientific method has four steps. Identify a problem and form a hypothesis that is testable and refutable, design an experiment, conduct it, then do hypothesis testing with statistics (Intro p.9).
- Feitelson (2006) gives three meanings of experimental CS. Building systems (hardware or software) as the counterpart to theory, experimentation as a feedback step in the engineering loop, and evaluating computer systems with the rigorous methods of the natural sciences. The third one is the focus of this class. Feitelson also argues there's a place for just observing the real world, like analyzing measured network traffic (Intro p.10).
- The figure on Intro p.11 compares the scientific method loop (observation, hypothesis or model, concrete prediction, experimental test) with the system design loop (idea, system design, concrete implementation, experimental evaluation).
- Course goals include understanding the trade-offs between simulation, measurement and analytical modeling, rigorously comparing systems in the presence of noise (often "quality" of output matters more than speed, like face recognition), and deciding if a change has a statistically significant impact (Intro p.13). Also using statistics to cut the number of simulations and designing experiments to get the most information for the effort (Intro p.14), drawing conclusions from noisy data (Intro p.15) and aggregating large data for a big-picture view (Intro p.16).
- Grading is 40% homework, 35% midterm, 25% term project. All work is individual under the Mason Honor Code. Lost homework points can be won back by resubmitting within two weeks. The term project should ideally use experimental methods tied to your 701 research (Intro p.8).
- Office hours Wednesday 1.30 to 2.30 PM in Nguyen 5305, GTA Mohammadreza Noei, Piazza for assignment discussion, material on Canvas (Intro p.8).
- Textbook is Lilja, "Measuring Computer Performance". Jain is the alternative and somewhat dated (Intro p.7).
- LaTeX is required for all homework submissions (Intro p.26).

Likely exam questions

1. **Q.** What are the three definitions of experimental CS, and which one is this course about?
   A. Building systems, experimentation as feedback in the engineering loop, and evaluating systems with the rigorous methods of the natural sciences. This course is about the third one (Intro p.10).
2. **Q.** You get 90 on homework, 80 on the midterm, 85 on the project. What's your grade?
   A. Rule. Grade is the weighted mean $0.40\,H + 0.35\,M + 0.25\,P$ (weights from Intro p.8). Plug in $H = 90$, $M = 80$, $P = 85$. Step 1, homework $0.40 \times 90 = 36$. Step 2, midterm $0.35 \times 80 = 28$. Step 3, project $0.25 \times 85 = 21.25$. Step 4, add $36 + 28 + 21.25 = 85.25$. Result 85.25. Check, it must land between 80 and 90 since the weights sum to 1.
3. **Q.** Why was CS 700 changed in 2018?
   A. The PhD program was restructured to reduce time to completion, so the course now also gives a broader introduction to the research process (Intro p.2).
4. **Q.** What must a hypothesis be in the scientific method?
   A. Testable and refutable (Intro p.9).

1. Selecting your PhD advisor (Advisor deck)

The big idea

Picking your research advisor is the biggest decision of your PhD. You can't rush it. Most professors want to work with you informally for a semester or more first, so both sides can see if it's a good fit. Start early, do your homework on their papers, and don't open with "will you be my advisor?".

Facts

- The talk is based on a presentation by Prof. Hakan Aydin, director of the CS PhD program (Advisor p.2).
- Every PhD student gets an **academic** advisor at admission, usually someone with compatible interests. The actual **research** advisor is declared by separate paperwork within the first **24 credits**, which is a hard deadline (Advisor p.3).
- It's the most important decision of the PhD. It may decide your success in the program, how long the PhD takes and your long-term career path. Choosing the advisor and choosing the research area go hand in hand (Advisor p.4).
- "Easy" case. You were already in close contact with a faculty member during admission, so they're probably your academic advisor and maybe already your GRA boss. You know each other. You still go through an initial research phase before officially declaring, and the checklist still helps (Advisor p.5).
- Common case. You have a broad idea of your interests but should stay open-minded. Find faculty in those or close areas, read their recent projects and papers, and contact them after doing that homework (Advisor p.6).
- Three misconceptions are on Advisor p.7. Delaying the search to the last semester because the deadline is 24 credits. Thinking faculty X will agree just because you want X. Thinking faculty will answer "can you be my advisor?" right away or within a few weeks. All three are wrong.
- **PRCP** means Preliminary Research Co-Operation Phase. It's an unofficial early research involvement before a professor agrees to advise you, unless they already know you from prior publications or class work. It may take one semester or more and lets both sides judge fit (Advisor p.8).

- PRCP is a term Prof. Aydin made up for the talk. It's not an official procedure, but nearly all faculty agree an initial phase matters (Advisor p.9).
- PRCP parts are weekly or biweekly meetings, discussing old and new papers, discussing ideas, group research meetings and working on a real (maybe limited) project. CS 701 in spring, mandatory for PhD students, is a great formal PRCP (Advisor p.10).
- Fall timing. Use Fall to plan your first research involvement, attend research talks (including the CS 700 ones), request meetings with faculty, explain your background and interests, ask how to get involved. Don't ask "can you be my PhD advisor?" this early (Advisor p.11).
- Faculty side. Dedicated students with good backgrounds and work ethic are the most important asset for research-active faculty. They still may decline because they're already over-committed with advisees (advising takes a lot of time) or they saw a mismatch in the PRCP (Advisor p.12).
- Positive signs faculty look for (the more the better) are good background in the area, willingness to learn by reading and discussing papers, being independent and open to brainstorming, proposing new good ideas, and being able to join their actual research right away even in a limited way (Advisor p.13).
- Student side. During the PRCP look for answers to key questions before committing. Don't expect all answers after one meeting or a few weeks (Advisor p.14).
- You'll work closely with this person for the rest of your PhD. Ask if their research approach and style match you, and if not, whether you can adapt (Advisor p.15).
- "Making progress in research" is vague. Peer-reviewed research is the ultimate objective. Ask what submission or publication numbers and pace they expect and if you're comfortable with it, but don't underestimate how productive you'll become (Advisor p.16).
- Ask how they interact with students (regular meetings, as needed, guidance by a postdoc), whether you want a hands-on or hands-off advisor (each has pros and cons), and funding odds if becoming a GRA next year matters to you (Advisor p.17).
- Ask how they pick students' research projects and dissertation topics, and how much the student gets a say (Advisor p.18).
- Co-advising. Two faculty can co-advise, but only one is declared the official advisor. The thesis names both. Their areas are usually related but complementary. Ask if they're open to it and have done it before. It has pros and cons (Advisor p.19).
- Changing advisor is technically possible and sometimes unavoidable, but it's a last resort. That's why the informal early phase is so important (Advisor p.20).
- Wrap-up. Most faculty take their time before accepting new students. Think carefully yourself, do your homework and show you're committed once you start talking with someone (Advisor p.21).
- More advice is in the CRA-W Grad Cohort workshop talks online ("Resources from Past Years"). The department may sponsor you to attend (Advisor p.22).

Likely exam questions

1. **Q.** True or false. The academic advisor assigned at admission is your official research advisor.
   A. False. The research advisor is declared with separate paperwork within the first 24 credits (Advisor p.3).
2. **Q.** True or false. Since the deadline is 24 credits, I can wait until my last semester to look for an advisor.
   A. False. It's the first misconception on Advisor p.7. The informal PRCP alone can take a semester or more (Advisor p.8), so waiting makes you miss the deadline.
3. **Q.** What is the PRCP and is it an official GMU procedure?
   A. It's an informal phase of working together, one semester or more, before a professor agrees to advise you, so both sides can check fit (Advisor p.8). It's not official. Prof. Aydin made up the name (Advisor p.9).
4. **Q.** Give two reasons a professor may say no to a good student.
   A. They're already over-committed with PhD advisees, since advising takes a lot of time, or they noticed a mismatch during the PRCP (Advisor p.12).
5. **Q.** A student emails a professor in week 2 asking "Can you be my PhD advisor?" and waits for a reply before contacting anyone else. What's wrong?
   A. Asking that this early is what Advisor p.11 says to avoid. Instead read their papers and ask for a meeting about getting involved (Advisor p.6, p.11). Expecting a quick reply is a misconception (Advisor p.7), and faculty take their time (Advisor p.21).
6. **Q.** With co-advising, how many official advisors are there?
   A. One. Only one is declared official, but the thesis names both (Advisor p.19).

2. CS 701 and the CS 700 term project (CS701 deck)

The big idea

CS 701 is a required spring course where each first-year PhD student does a semester-long research project with one faculty supervisor. There are no classes. You and your supervisor sign a form that works like a contract with the department, then you do real hands-on research, write a report and give a short talk. The form is due Oct 31, so you need a supervisor now.

Facts about CS 701

- Full name is Research Experience in Computer Science. Mandatory for all first-year PhD CS students. Offered **only in Spring**. Must be passed with **B or better**. Prerequisite is **B or better in CS 700** (CS701 p.2).
- Each student pairs with a CS faculty supervisor for a semester-long project. The point is to interact with faculty and get research experience (CS701 p.3).
- At the end the student submits a **report to the supervisor**, every 701 student gives a short public talk of about **10 minutes** to the whole department, and the **supervisor submits the grade** to the registrar (CS701 p.3).
- Registration. Find a CS faculty member willing to supervise. Fill out the CS 701 form with the project details (description and deliverables). Student and supervisor sign it. Submit it to `csphd@gmu.edu` and `aydin@cs.gmu.edu`. The department must approve it and may ask for revisions (CS701 p.4).
- The form is a **3-way contract** among the student, the supervisor and the CS department (CS701 p.4).
- After approval the department gives you a **CRN** (course reference number), and you use it to register on **PatriotWeb**. The form, revisions and getting the CRN all take time (CS701 p.5).
- Who can supervise. Any **tenure-track or tenured** CS faculty, meaning assistant, associate or full professors. Not people whose directory title says "Teaching" or "Instructor" (CS701 p.6).
- You can have a **co-supervisor**, who co-signs the form. CS-affiliated faculty can co-supervise. Even with a co-supervisor, the registrar records the course under one CS faculty member (CS701 p.6).
- Email the form to `csphd@gmu.edu` with the subject line "[CS701 form]" and cc `aydin@cs.gmu.edu`. Submitting on time is critical. **Deadline Oct 31, 2026** (CS701 p.7).
- **No regular class meetings.** Student and supervisor meet periodically or as needed. Any required meeting pattern (weekly, biweekly) goes on the form. Periodic meetings help you stay in touch and discuss progress and unclear points (CS701 p.8).
- The project doesn't have to be groundbreaking or immediately publishable. But the effort must match a **3-credit semester-long course** for first-year PhD students. It's much more than a

regular course's term project. Don't expect to finish by "sprinting" in the last few weeks. Timely planning and progress in spring is critical (CS701 p.9).
- Literature review or paper reading is likely needed first and is an essential part of many projects. But the project **can't be only** a literature review or survey (CS701 p.10).
- A **hands-on** (implementation) part is required beyond the literature review. Software, simulations or experiments. For a Theoretical CS project, working on a proof for a non-trivial open problem or a non-trivial novel complexity analysis is also OK (CS701 p.11).
- Implementing a set of techniques from possibly several papers and evaluating them thoroughly, possibly with new performance metrics, is fine. Proposing new techniques or extending existing ones is also reasonable. Discuss details with the supervisor (CS701 p.12).
- Form field "Description of the research activity". Must be **more than a title**, about one paragraph (attach sheets if needed), and must state the hands-on part (CS701 p.13).
- Form field "Deliverables and other requirements". A **project report is the default and mandatory** deliverable. List other requirements like software or hardware artefacts and periodic meetings. The report goes to the supervisor at the end of spring. Ask the supervisor about format and length (CS701 p.14).
- A conference or journal submission completed by the end of spring **can't** be a deliverable. "A draft paper to be revised and submitted for publication in the future" **is** OK, and the report can then be that draft paper (CS701 p.15).
- A successful 701 can be the first step to an advisor relationship, but that's not the primary intent. Many students end up with a different area and advisor than their 701 (CS701 p.18).
- Suggested steps (CS701 p.27). (1) Identify a few CS faculty in your preferred areas. (2) Contact them and request meetings about possible projects. (3) Collect information from the ones who are available. (4) Decide, fill out the form, get the faculty signature and submit it to `csphd@gmu.edu` and `aydin@cs.gmu.edu`. If nobody in the first group is available, pick a second group (maybe a different area) and repeat.

The 701 misconceptions, myth then truth

- *Myth.* My 701 supervisor automatically becomes my PhD advisor. *Truth.* No. Declaring the PhD advisor is a separate process with a separate form within the first 24 credits (CS701 p.16).
- *Myth.* My dissertation will be in the area of my 701 project. *Truth.* Not necessarily. You can do 701 in area X and the dissertation in area Y (CS701 p.17).
- *Myth.* My first-choice professor will agree. *Truth.* Not necessarily, they may be unavailable for various reasons (CS701 p.19).
- *Myth.* After I contact a professor, we'll meet and decide quickly. *Truth.* No guarantee (CS701 p.20).
- *Myth.* I should wait for the first professor's answer before contacting a second. *Truth.* You shouldn't. Contact several faculty and learn about different projects, to save time (CS701 p.21).
- *Myth.* I can work with only one faculty member. *Truth.* You can have co-supervisors, but only one is the official primary supervisor, and that one must be tenured or tenure-track CS faculty. The registrar records the primary. The co-supervisor can be CS-affiliated faculty, is named next to the primary on the form and co-signs it. You can acknowledge the co-supervisor in the report and talk (CS701 p.22).
- *Myth.* I can wait until late October to search. *Truth.* That would be a big mistake (CS701 p.23).
- *Myth.* If I'm a GRA, my sponsor will be my 701 supervisor. *Truth.* That's most natural but not required (CS701 p.24).
- *Myth.* If I can't find a project in my favorite area, I'll take 701 next year. *Truth.* Not possible, it's a catalog rule (CS701 p.25).
- *Myth.* If I can't find a supervisor, the department will assign one. *Truth.* No. A CS faculty member has to agree to supervise (CS701 p.26).

Facts about the CS 700 term project

- **Individual** project. Pick an experimental CS problem with quantitative analysis of a computer system, technique, algorithm or method. Comparing several techniques quantitatively is also fine. Do the experiments or analysis and write a report (CS701 p.28).
- Must include **experiments and/or simulations**, and you must apply class statistics like confidence intervals and regression (CS701 p.29).
- Ideally pick a topic in your research area, even better tied to your 701, but that's **not required and not graded** (CS701 p.29).
- **Not acceptable** are a literature survey of quantitative or statistical techniques, and applying statistics to polls or surveys (CS701 p.29).
- **1-page proposal** as a PDF on Canvas. It briefly covers the problem or algorithms, the experimental techniques and the methodology. The slide says due midnight Sunday Oct 25, but it was moved to **Nov 2** (CS701 p.30).
- **Status update by Nov 15**, reporting any changes or unexpected problems (CS701 p.30).
- **Dec 7** class is for **5-minute** presentations covering the problem, the techniques you implemented or simulated, and preliminary results (CS701 p.31).
- Final report is a **6-8 page** technical report in an **ACM or IEEE** conference template, submitted on Canvas **by Dec 7** (CS701 p.32).

Likely exam questions

1. **Q.** When is CS 701 offered, what grade is needed, and what's the prerequisite?
   A. Spring only, B or better, and B or better in CS 700 (CS701 p.2).
2. **Q.** A draft form lists an "Assistant Professor, Teaching" as supervisor, the description "Federated learning", the work "read and summarize 15 papers", and the deliverable "paper submitted to INFOCOM by May". Fix every problem.
   A. The supervisor must be tenured or tenure-track, and "Teaching" titles don't qualify (CS701 p.6). That person could only co-supervise and co-sign next to a tenure-line CS primary (CS701 p.22). The description is just a title and must be a paragraph naming the hands-on part (CS701 p.13). A literature review alone isn't allowed (CS701 p.10), so add implementation, simulation or experiments (CS701 p.11). A conference submission can't be a deliverable, but "a draft paper to be revised and submitted in the future" can (CS701 p.15). The mandatory report must be listed (CS701 p.14).
3. **Q.** Who gets the CS 701 form, and what happens after approval?
   A. Email it to csphd@gmu.edu with "[CS701 form]" in the subject and cc aydin@cs.gmu.edu (CS701 p.7). The department approves it or asks for a revision (CS701 p.4), then gives you a CRN to register on PatriotWeb (CS701 p.5).
4. **Q.** True or false. The 701 project must be publishable, so it can be small.
   A. False both ways. It doesn't need to be groundbreaking or publishable, but the effort must match a full 3-credit course, much more than a term project (CS701 p.9).
5. **Q.** Which is acceptable as a CS 700 term project? (a) CIs on a survey of 40 classmates' IDE preference. (b) A review of how papers use regression. (c) Timing two hash tables 30 runs each at four load factors, compared with CIs and regression.
   A. Only (c). (a) applies statistics to a poll, and (b) is a literature survey of statistical techniques, both banned (CS701 p.29). (c) is an individual quantitative comparison with experiments

and class methods (CS701 p.28-29).

6. **Q.** Give the term project deadlines.
   A. Proposal Nov 2 (slide says Oct 25), status update Nov 15, 5-minute talk Dec 7, 6-8 page ACM or IEEE report Dec 7 (CS701 p.30-32).

3. Publication practices in CS (Pub deck)

The big idea

A PhD means doing original research good enough to pass peer review, where other experts judge your paper before it's published. In CS the main venues are conferences, and they're very competitive. Good results aren't enough, because there are a fixed number of slots and writing and organization count too. Rejection is normal, so you fix the paper and resubmit. Never send the same paper to two places at once.

Facts

- A PhD needs original research ending in a dissertation you write and defend. The research must be worthy of publication in peer-reviewed journals and/or conference proceedings (Pub p.2).
- **Peer review** means experts ("peers") review articles before they're officially published or presented. The aim is to keep science honest by filtering out invalid or poor-quality work. Reviewers evaluate independently. Journal editors or conference chairs make the final decision, sometimes after discussion (Pub p.3).
- Why publish. It shows other experts, not just you, your advisor or your group, approve your work. It makes the work widely accessible. Your publication record is your main track record. The slide flags quality vs quantity (Pub p.4).
- Long-term impact is often correlated with the number of **citations**. Important papers can get hundreds or thousands. Citation counts are used to judge researchers and even venues (Pub p.5).
- **h-index** is the largest h such that an author (or journal) has at least h papers each cited at least h times. Slide example, citations 10, 9, 8, 6, 3, 1 (already sorted). Rank 1, $10 \geq 1$ yes. Rank 2, $9 \geq 2$ yes. Rank 3, $8 \geq 3$ yes. Rank 4, $6 \geq 4$ yes. Rank 5, $3 \geq 5$ no. So $h = 4$, since four papers have 4 or more but there aren't five with 5 or more. PhD students' h-index usually isn't high even at the end, but it grows as you publish more good papers (Pub p.6).
- How to compute h. Sort citations from high to low. Go down the list. h is the last rank i where the count is still $\geq i$. The answer is a number of papers, not a citation count.
- Most PhD students start publishing peer-reviewed papers during or after their **3rd year**. It takes time to build background, find a problem, solve it, learn to write a scholarly paper and beat other researchers (Pub p.7).
- Knowing the process early helps you appreciate the competition and build reading, evaluating, writing and presenting skills alongside your research (Pub p.8).
- Venue types are conferences, journals and workshops (Pub p.10).
- Conferences solicit papers on a topic. The **call for papers (CFP)** gives dates, topics, formatting rules and the organizing committee. Authors submit by a deadline and wait for accept or reject. The decision includes comments from **anonymous reviewers** who are on the **program committee (PC)** (Pub p.11).
- Format per the CFP, meaning page limits, font size limits and IEEE or ACM templates. Deadlines might be extended, less likely for first-tier conferences, so never rely on it (Pub p.12).
- **Acceptance rate** is the percent of papers accepted, so rate = accepted ÷ submitted ×100%. For example 60 accepted out of 400 submitted is $60/400 = 0.15$, which is 15%, inside the first-tier range. Lower rate generally means more prestige. First-tier conferences are usually **10-25%**, sometimes under 10%. Your advisor can tell you how competitive venues are, since picking the right venue isn't trivial (Pub p.13).
- Decision process. The PC chair assigns papers to PC members (professors or industry researchers). Each writes an independent review scoring **writing quality, organization, technical contribution and novelty**, with a final recommendation of Strong Accept, Accept, Neutral, Reject or Strong Reject. Note the impact of non-technical factors (Pub p.14).
- The PC meets to discuss all papers and decide, which can take all day or several days. Each conference has a **fixed number of slots** (about 30 to 1000+). Often not all above-threshold papers fit, so some quite reasonable papers get rejected. The PC in a sense "orders" the good papers (Pub p.15).
- Big conferences have **Area Chairs (ACs)** appointed by the PC chair, each overseeing reviews in a sub-area (Pub p.16).
- **Rebuttal**. Increasingly, reviews are released before the final decision so authors can clear up misunderstandings. Not every paper gets this, many are directly accepted or rejected. Author replies are considered in the decision (Pub p.17).
- Accepted papers are resubmitted as a **camera-ready copy** by another deadline, with reviewer comments included when possible. Authors present them at the conference, which is a chance to network and travel (Pub p.18).
- On rejection, don't take it personally or treat it like failing an exam. Use the comments to improve, and talk with your advisor and co-authors about revising and resubmitting to another venue or the same conference's next edition (Pub p.19).
- **Dual submission** is sending the same or mostly the same paper to several venues at once, usually to raise acceptance odds, or trying to get a second paper from the same material. Not allowed. It's often caught and authors get severe sanctions (Pub p.20).
- **Anonymity**. Authors never know the reviewers. In **double-blind** review, increasingly common, reviewers don't know the authors either. The CFP then asks authors to leave off names and affiliations and avoid indirect hints. A non-compliant paper is rejected right away (Pub p.21). The slide asks why it's spreading. The usual answer is so a famous name or school can't sway the reviewers and the paper is judged on content.

The 8 publication misconceptions (Pub p.9), all false

1. A publication is basically a graduate-level project report.
2. If the results are correct, my paper will be accepted.
3. If the results are correct, important and novel, it will be accepted.
4. If my advisor says "it's good", it will be accepted.
5. If my paper is rejected, the conference made an error or is biased.
6. My paper was rejected, so all that time and effort was wasted.
7. Only publishing matters, the venue isn't important.
8. The number of publications matters, not quality.

Why they're false. Slots are fixed so good papers get rejected (Pub p.15), non-technical things like writing and organization are scored (Pub p.14), rejection comments help you improve and resubmit (Pub p.19), venue prestige differs (Pub p.13), and quality counts over quantity (Pub p.4).

Likely exam questions

1. **Q.** Find the h-index for citations 5, 15, 2, 6, 11, 0, 6, 1.
   A. Rule. h is the largest h with at least h papers cited at least h times (Pub p.6). Step 1, sort high to low to get 15, 11, 6, 6, 5, 2, 1, 0. Step 2, compare each count with its rank. Rank 1, $15 \geq 1$ yes. Rank 2, $11 \geq 2$ yes. Rank 3, $6 \geq 3$ yes. Rank 4, $6 \geq 4$ yes. Rank 5, $5 \geq 5$ yes. Rank 6, $2 \geq 6$ no, so stop. Step 3, the last rank that passed is 5. Result $h = 5$. Five papers have at least 5 citations, but there aren't six with at least 6.
2. **Q.** An author has 3 papers with 500 citations each. What's h?
   A. Rule as above (Pub p.6). Step 1, sorted list is 500, 500, 500.

Step 2, rank 1, $500 \geq 1$ yes. Rank 2, $500 \geq 2$ yes. Rank 3, $500 \geq 3$ yes. There's no rank 4 paper, so h can't be 4. Result $h = 3$. Huge citation counts can't push h past the number of papers.

3. **Q.** True or false. If my results are correct, important and novel, a good conference will accept it.
   A. False. It's a listed misconception (Pub p.9). There's a fixed number of slots so reasonable papers get rejected (Pub p.15), and writing quality and organization are scored too (Pub p.14).
4. **Q.** Name the four review criteria and the five recommendations.
   A. Writing quality, organization, technical contribution and novelty. Strong Accept, Accept, Neutral, Reject, Strong Reject (Pub p.14).
5. **Q.** What must authors do for double-blind review, and what if they don't?
   A. Leave names and affiliations off and avoid indirect hints about who they are. A non-compliant paper is rejected right away (Pub p.21).
6. **Q.** A student submits the same paper to two conferences to improve the odds, planning to withdraw one. Is that OK?
   A. No. That's dual submission, which isn't allowed, is often caught and gets severe sanctions (Pub p.20, Ethics p.14).

4. Research integrity and ethics (Ethics deck, plus Luke TR)

The big idea

You must do research honestly. The three big sins are making up data (fabrication), changing or dropping data (falsification) and using others' words or ideas without credit (plagiarism). Coursework falls under the Honor Code, but research and your dissertation fall under GMU Policy 4007. Citing doesn't make copied words OK, you need quotes or your own words. AI is usually allowed if you disclose it and take full responsibility.

Facts on rules and who governs what

- The PhD goal is original research and contributions to your field, but done ethically and with the highest integrity (Ethics p.2).
- Coursework and academic activities are governed by the **GMU Honor Code**. Research activities, including dissertation research, are governed by **GMU Policy 4007** (Misconduct in Research and Scholarship) (Ethics p.3).
- IEEE, ACM and IFIP each have a Code of Ethics and Professional Conduct for their submissions and publications (Ethics p.4). Much of the deck is adapted from the IEEE Author Ethics Guidelines (Ethics p.5).
- IEEE keeps a list of authors penalized for ethics violations. They can't publish for extended periods, and IEEE informs their institutions, which usually add their own sanctions (Ethics p.6).
- Policy 4007 misconduct is monitored and investigated by GMU's **Office of Research Integrity and Assurance (ORIA)** (Ethics p.15).
- Policy 4007 covers all full-time and part-time employees and anyone affiliated with GMU, graduate students doing research or scholarship producing reports, conference papers, publications or creative works that list GMU affiliation, undergraduates in sponsored research, and anyone at GMU who teaches, researches or does scholarship (Ethics p.16).
- For graduate students, academic misconduct goes **solely through the Honor Code**, except (1) research activities, whether sponsored or not, and (2) master's theses and doctoral dissertations. Those two go through Policy 4007 (Ethics p.16).
- All research misconduct allegations are handled under 4007. The university aims for an impartial, unbiased process. Investigators are chosen for relevant expertise and screened beforehand for bias or personal, professional or financial conflicts of interest. Everyone must keep it confidential and cooperate (Ethics p.17).
- **Research misconduct** means fabrication, falsification or plagiarism in proposing, performing or reviewing research, or in reporting results. Fabricating or falsifying credentials on funding applications and manuscripts can count. It **does not include honest error or differences of opinion** (Ethics p.18).
- 4007 sets rules to receive and review allegations, runs inquiries and investigations (committees, hearings) and communicates results (Ethics p.19).
- GMU offers in-person **Responsible Conduct in Research (RCR)** training through ORIA (Ethics p.21).

FFP definitions (Policy 4007, Ethics p.20)

- **Fabrication**. Making up data or results and recording or reporting them. Slide short form is "inventing or making up data or results" (Ethics p.13).
- **Falsification**. Manipulating research materials, equipment or processes, or changing or omitting data or results, so the research isn't accurately represented. Slide short form adds manipulating equipment or software (Ethics p.13).
- **Plagiarism**. Taking another person's ideas, processes, results or words without appropriate credit.
- Even if you can't explain some trends right away, don't omit or manipulate them. Another group will likely have a similar implementation and get the real results (Ethics p.13).
- Quick test. Never measured it? Fabrication. Measured it but changed, hid or tweaked it? Falsification. Someone else's words or ideas without credit? Plagiarism.

Facts on plagiarism and citing

- IEEE defines plagiarism as using another researcher's ideas, results or words without explicitly acknowledging the original author and source. Plagiarism in any form is unacceptable and a serious breach of professional conduct with possibly severe ethical and legal consequences (Ethics p.7).
- Always cite. For a **direct quotation**, put the verbatim text in quotation marks and cite the source (Ethics p.8).
- Usually better is to **paraphrase or summarize** with an in-text citation, for ideas, processes, arguments or conclusions (Ethics p.9).
- Copying the sentence with no quotes and no citation is plagiarism (Ethics p.10).
- Data, results, information, graphics and tables also need a citation to the original whenever you refer to, adapt or reuse them (Ethics p.11).
- **Self-plagiarism**. The same rules apply to your own published work. Rephrase instead of cut and paste. Exception is extending your own conference paper to a journal submission (Ethics p.12).
- **Multiple or concurrent submissions**. A submission must not be under review or already published elsewhere, and that includes papers with substantial overlap. Check with organizers and your advisor if in doubt (Ethics p.14).
- **Conference to journal**. The journal version needs substantially more material, typically **30% more for IEEE**, and must cite and include as an attachment the conference version, explaining the differences (Ethics p.14).

Luke's plagiarism report

- Plagiarism is the **second worst** thing in research. The worst is faking your experiments. Plagiarists are often fired, publicly denounced by coauthors, and PhD students get disowned by advisors and thrown out. Avoid even the appearance of plagiarism (Luke TR p.1).
- You can plagiarize someone's **words** or their **descriptive idea**. Light rewording isn't enough unless the idea is well-known and general (Luke TR p.1).
- It harms two groups, the source who loses credit and readers misled into thinking you came up with it. Plagiarism is an ethical offense, copyright violation is a separate legal one you can

be sued for. It's not allowed anywhere in a paper, including abstract, intro, conclusion, tutorial material and especially related work (Luke TR p.1).
- Pasted text is plagiarism (Ex. 1). Pasted text plus a citation is still plagiarism (Ex. 2). Pasted text naming the authors and citing is still plagiarism, since the words are still stolen (Ex. 3) (Luke TR p.2).
- Using less of their text, more than a phrase, is still open to accusation. Under a phrase is relatively safe (Ex. 4). Light rewording with the same structure plagiarizes the idea. Never reword "to avoid plagiarizing", write in your own words from the start (Ex. 5). Rewriting in your own words without looking at the source is much better, but a quote is better still (Ex. 6) (Luke TR p.2).
- An offset block quote with citation is fine, but don't quote huge chunks without reason (Ex. 7). An inline quote in quotation marks is OK, but offset larger ones (Ex. 8) (Luke TR p.3).
- An equation copied without attribution is plagiarism, since math is dense text (Ex. 9). "As Luke and Panait have shown [1], the update rule is…" is dangerously close (Ex. 10). "The update rule (from Luke and Panait [1]) is" is acceptable. Standard notation like the Bellman equation needn't be cited, but when in doubt cite (Ex. 11). More than a few equations needs permission from the author and maybe the publisher (Ex. 12) (Luke TR p.3).
- A copied figure with no citation is plagiarism (Ex. 13). A copied figure with citation isn't plagiarism but is **copyright violation**, because figures are the author's creation and take more effort (Ex. 14). Use a figure only with permission, stated in the caption, however small (Ex. 15). Copying the original caption is plagiarism, treat captions like body text (Ex. 16) (Luke TR p.4).
- An identical bibliography entry is fine since formats are rigid (Ex. 17). A small algorithm clearly marked as from the source is OK, though rewriting it is better (Ex. 18). A large algorithm (a third of a page or more) is like a figure and needs author and publisher permission, and still looks like padding (Ex. 19) (Luke TR p.5).

Facts on AI use

- In general AI tools are OK in submissions if the use is acknowledged in detail and authors take full responsibility, including for any resulting plagiarism or falsification. Check the venue's current rules, which keep changing (Ethics p.22).
- **IEEE**. Any AI-generated content (text, figures, images, code) must be disclosed in the **acknowledgments**. Name the AI system, identify the sections that used it and briefly explain how much. Editing and grammar help is generally outside the policy, but disclosure is still **recommended** (Ethics p.23).
- **ACM**. Generative AI like ChatGPT **can't be listed as an author**. Using it to create content is permitted but must be fully disclosed, for example in the Acknowledgements. When unsure, disclose. Basic word processing that suggests text, spelling and grammar checks, and translation tools are **exempt and need not be disclosed**. The policy will be updated as the line with tools like MS-Word or Grammarly blurs (Ethics p.24).
- **Elsevier**. AI only to improve readability and language, not to replace key tasks like producing scientific insights or drawing conclusions. Disclose it in the manuscript and a statement appears in the published work. AI can't be an author or co-author or be cited as an author (Ethics p.25).
- **ICML 2024 CFP**. LLMs are allowed as general writing aids. Authors take full responsibility, including for LLM content that's plagiarism or fabrication. LLMs can't be authors (Ethics p.26).
- Always check the latest CFP or journal website. If it says nothing, the organization's general rules (IEEE, ACM) apply. Ask the organizers and your advisor if unsure (Ethics p.27).

Likely exam questions

1. **Q.** Classify each. (a) Two of 30 timing runs are slow and unexplained, so you delete them. (b) A simulator crashed, so you fill the table cell with an interpolated value and don't say so. (c) You copy a sentence from a paper without quotes or citation. (d) You report a wrong mean because of a spreadsheet typo you didn't notice.
   A. (a) Falsification, since omitting data misrepresents the research (Ethics p.20, p.13). (b) Fabrication, a result that was never measured is reported (Ethics p.20). (c) Plagiarism (Ethics p.10, p.20). (d) Not misconduct, it's honest error (Ethics p.18).
2. **Q.** A grad student is accused of misconduct on a homework and, separately, in their dissertation. Which rules apply?
   A. The homework goes through the Honor Code. The dissertation goes through Policy 4007, investigated by ORIA (Ethics p.16, p.15).
3. **Q.** You copy a paragraph word for word, write "As Luke and Panait have pointed out" and add [1]. Plagiarism?
   A. Yes. The idea is credited but the words are passed off as yours (Luke TR p.2, Ex. 3). Use quotation marks or a block quote (Luke TR p.3, Ex. 7-8, Ethics p.8), or paraphrase with a citation (Ethics p.9).
4. **Q.** You put another paper's figure in yours with "from [1]" in the caption. Plagiarism? OK?
   A. Not plagiarism but not OK. It's copyright violation (Luke TR p.4, Ex. 14). Get author and maybe publisher permission and write "reproduced with permission from [1]" in the caption (Ex. 15).
5. **Q.** You turn your 10-page conference paper into an IEEE journal paper. What's required?
   A. Rule. The journal version needs typically 30% more material for IEEE (Ethics p.14), so new length is old length $\times 1.30$. Plug in 10 pages. Step 1, $10 \times 1.30 = 13$ pages' worth. Step 2, new material is $13 - 10 = 3$ pages. Result, about 3 pages of genuinely new content. Also cite and attach the conference version and explain the differences (Ethics p.14). Reusing your own conference text is the allowed self-plagiarism exception (Ethics p.12).
6. **Q.** Can ChatGPT be a co-author on an ACM paper? Must you disclose a grammar checker?
   A. No, AI can't be an author, and content it creates must be fully disclosed (Ethics p.24). A grammar checker is exempt under ACM. Under IEEE it's outside the policy but disclosure is recommended (Ethics p.23).

Myth vs truth across all four lectures

Myth (false)	Truth	Cite
My academic advisor from admission is my research advisor	Research advisor is declared separately within 24 credits	Advisor p.3
The 24-credit deadline lets me search in my last semester	Too late, PRCP alone can take a semester or more	Advisor p.7-8
If I want to work with X, X will agree	Not guaranteed, they may be over-committed or see a mismatch	Advisor p.7, p.12
Faculty answer "be my advisor?" within weeks	Most faculty take their time	Advisor p.7, p.21
PRCP is an official GMU procedure	Aydin's own term, not official	Advisor p.9
Co-advised students have two official advisors	One official advisor, thesis names both	Advisor p.19

Myth (false)	Truth	Cite
Changing advisor is a normal step	Possible but a last resort	Advisor p.20
My 701 supervisor becomes my PhD advisor	Separate form within 24 credits	CS701 p.16
My dissertation will be in my 701 area	Can do 701 in X and dissertation in Y	CS701 p.17
My first-choice professor will agree	They may be unavailable	CS701 p.19
A meeting and a quick decision will follow	No guarantee	CS701 p.20
Wait for one professor before asking another	Contact several at once	CS701 p.21
Only one faculty member can work with me	Co-supervisors allowed, one official tenure-line CS primary	CS701 p.22
I can start searching in late October	Big mistake, form due Oct 31	CS701 p.23, p.7
My GRA sponsor must be my 701 supervisor	Natural but not required	CS701 p.24
I can take 701 next year instead	Not possible, catalog rule	CS701 p.25
The department will assign a supervisor	Faculty must agree to supervise	CS701 p.26
701 can be just a literature review	Needs a hands-on part	CS701 p.10-11
A conference submission can be a 701 deliverable	No, but a draft paper for later submission can	CS701 p.15
701 needn't be publishable so it can be small	Effort of a 3-credit course, no sprinting	CS701 p.9
A publication is like a grad project report	False, peer reviewed in a competition	Pub p.9, p.3
Correct results get accepted	False, fixed slots and writing is scored	Pub p.9, p.14-15
Correct, important and novel gets accepted	Still not guaranteed	Pub p.9, p.15
My advisor says it's good, so it'll be accepted	False	Pub p.9
Rejection means the conference erred or is biased	Reasonable papers are rejected for lack of slots	Pub p.9, p.15
Rejection wastes all the effort	Use comments to improve and resubmit	Pub p.9, p.19
Venue doesn't matter	Lower acceptance rate means more prestige	Pub p.9, p.13
Number of papers matters, not quality	Quality vs quantity	Pub p.9, p.4
Every paper gets a rebuttal	Many are directly accepted or rejected	Pub p.17
Dual submission is fine if I withdraw one later	Not allowed, severe sanctions	Pub p.20
Citing a source makes pasted text OK	Still plagiarism without quotes	Luke TR p.2, Ethics p.8
A cited figure is fine	Copyright violation, need permission	Luke TR p.4
Light rewording avoids plagiarism	Same structure still plagiarizes the idea	Luke TR p.2
Reusing my own published text is fine	Self-plagiarism, except conf to journal	Ethics p.12
Dropping unexplained data is OK	That's falsification	Ethics p.13, p.20
An honest error is research misconduct	Not misconduct	Ethics p.18
Dissertation misconduct goes to the Honor Code	Policy 4007	Ethics p.16
AI can be a co-author if disclosed	Never an author (ACM, Elsevier, ICML)	Ethics p.24-26
Disclosing AI shifts responsibility to the tool	Authors take full responsibility	Ethics p.22

Every homework problem from HW0 and HW2 to HW6, in the form the exam is likely to copy. Each one starts with **In plain words**, which says what the question really wants. Then every calculation goes in the same four beats. *Formula* gives the formula in symbols with each symbol named. *Plug in* puts the real numbers in. *Work it out* does the arithmetic one step at a time. *Result* gives the number. The final answer is marked **Answer**. Every number below was recomputed in Python from the data files. Where the homework needed a computer there's a small version you can do with a pencil. Places where the submitted answer drifts from the slides or the source are marked **Check.** When an interval is built from rounded pieces the last digit can be 1 off from the listed answer, which came from unrounded values. Either is fine on the exam.

Table values used in this section

$z[0.05]$	1.645	$t[0.05, 15]$	1.753
$z[0.025]$	1.960	$t[0.025, 15]$	2.131
$z[0.01]$	2.326	$t[0.005, 15]$	2.947
$z[0.005]$	2.576	$t[\cdot, 3]$ at .05/.025/.005	2.353/3.182/5.841
$\Phi(0.33)$	0.6293	$t[0.025, 8]$	2.306
$\Phi(0.5)$	0.6915	$t[0.05, 8]$	1.860
$\Phi(0.83)$	0.7967	$t[0.05, 6]$	1.943
$\Phi(0.9)$	0.8159	$t[0.05, 37]$	1.687
$\Phi(1.3)$	0.9032	$t[0.025, 2]$	4.303
$\Phi(1.8)$	0.9641	$\Phi(0.21)$	0.5832
$\Phi(2.0)$	0.9772	$\Phi(0.67)$	0.7486
$\Phi(2.5)$	0.9938	$\Phi(1.38)$	0.9162
$t[0.05, 5]$	2.015	$t[0.025, 4]$	2.776
$t[0.05, 24]$	1.711	$t[0.10, 37]$	1.304
$z[0.20]$	0.84	$t[0.025, 7]$	2.365
$\Phi(2.4)$	0.9918	$t[0.025, 5]$	2.571

$z[a]$ is the upper-tail value with area a above it, so $z[0.025] = 1.960$ (CI p.30). $\Phi(z)$ is the area below z, which is the chance a standard normal lands below z. Handy roots are $\sqrt{50} = 7.071$, $\sqrt{12} = 3.464$, $\sqrt{3} = 1.732$, $\sqrt{6} = 2.449$, $\sqrt{5} = 2.236$.

Which homework to open for which exam question

If the exam asks you to	Model
compute a probability, mean or variance from a table	HW0 Q5 to Q9
judge a metric against the six criteria	HW2
pick and compute a mean (times, rates, ratios)	HW3 Q1
find quartiles, a histogram, a Q-Q plot	HW3 Q2
build a z or t CI and compare widths	HW4 P1
fix a CI for skewed data	HW4 P2
run a one-sample test, p-value, threshold	HW5 P1
set up H_0 and H_1 for a claim	HW5 P2
compare two systems, paired or Welch	HW6 P1, P2
audit a described experiment	HW4 to HW6 P3

Answer key at a glance (his submitted answers, all recomputed)

HW0 Q4	1/16, 15/16, 3/8
HW0 Q5	discrete, $\mu = 2.84$, Var 5.134, SD 2.27, COV 0.80
HW0 Q6	0.75, 0.425, $4/17 = 0.235$, $17/23 = 0.739$
HW0 Q7	mean 50, SD 23.09, 0.125, 0.375, 0.125
HW0 Q8	0.0873, 0.1841, 0.8159
HW0 Q9	0.321, 0.203, 0.309
HW3 Q1	GM 1.4294 (42.94%), AM 203.33 ms, HM 2485.66 tps
HW3 Q2	means 2.0142, 0.2083, s^2 1.0457, 0.0440, Q-Q r 0.9993, 0.904
HW4 P1	$\mu = 2.0142$, $\sigma^2 = 1.0447$, all six CIs contain μ, 95% widths 0.52 vs 1.21
HW4 P2	$\mu = 0.2083$, $\sigma^2 = 0.0440$, batched widest, bootstrap narrowest, 99% batched dips to -0.158
HW5 P1	$Z = 1.80$, fail to reject, $p = 0.0718$, threshold 2.843 h
HW5 P2	$H_1: \mu < 740$, $Z = -2.50$, reject, $p = 0.0062$
HW6 P1	paired, $\bar{d} = 0.611$, CI $(-10.77, 11.99)$, not shown
HW6 P2	Welch, $\nu = 37.89$, CI $(-1.540, 0.781)$, not shown

HW0. Probability refresher (ungraded, solved here)

HW0 Q1 and Q2. Independent events, and $P[A$ and $B]$

Question. *1. Explain what is meant by "independent events" in Probability theory. 2. If A and B are independent events, what is $P[A$ and $B]$?*

In plain words. Two events are independent when one happening tells you nothing about the other, like two separate coin flips. Then the chance that both happen is just the two chances multiplied. This is the rule that lets us treat repeated runs as separate pieces of evidence later in the course.

1. Q1. Independent means knowing B happened doesn't change the chance of A. In symbols $P[A \mid B] = P[A]$, where $P[A \mid B]$ is the chance of A once you already know B happened.
2. Q2. *Formula.* Multiplication rule $P[A \cap B] = P[A \mid B]\, P[B]$, where $A \cap B$ means A and B both happen.
3. *Plug in.* Independence lets you swap $P[A \mid B]$ for $P[A]$.
4. *Result.* $P[A \cap B] = P[A]\, P[B]$.
5. Example. Two fair coins. $P[\text{both heads}] = P[H_1]\, P[H_2] = 0.5 \times 0.5 = 0.25$.

Answer. Q1, independent means $P[A \mid B] = P[A]$, so one event carries no information about the other. Q2, $P[A \cap B] = P[A]\, P[B]$.

Usual mistake. Mixing up independent with mutually exclusive. Exclusive events with nonzero probability are never independent, since $P[A \cap B] = 0$. In the course, independence is what makes $\sigma/\sqrt{n}$ the right standard error (HT p.20, CI p.65).

HW0 Q3. $E[kX + mY]$ for constants k, m

Question. *If the expected values of two random variables X and Y are $E[X]$ and $E[Y]$, respectively, what is the expected value of $k \cdot X + m \cdot Y$ (i.e., $E[k \cdot X + m \cdot Y]$), if k and m are constants?*

In plain words. Expected value is the long-run average. Averages are linear, so scaling a variable scales its average, and the average of a sum is the sum of the averages. You don't need independence for this, only for the variance version.

1. *Formula.* $E[X] = \sum_x x\, P[X = x]$, each value times its chance, added up. It's a weighted sum (Summ p.10).
2. *Plug in.* $E[kX + mY] = \sum (kx + my)\, P[x, y]$ over all pairs of values.
3. *Work it out.* Split the sum into $k \sum x\, P[x, y] + m \sum y\, P[x, y]$. Each piece collapses to $E[X]$ and $E[Y]$.
4. *Result.* $E[kX + mY] = k\, E[X] + m\, E[Y]$.
5. Example. $E[X] = 3$, $E[Y] = 5$, $k = 2$, $m = -1$ gives $2(3) + (-1)(5) = 6 - 5 = 1$.

Answer. $k\,E[X] + m\,E[Y]$, with or without independence.

Usual mistake. Doing the same for variance. $\text{Var}(X - Y) = \sigma_X^2 + \sigma_Y^2 - 2\rho\sigma_X\sigma_Y$ needs the correlation, and that term is exactly what pairing buys (Comp p.6). With $k = 1$, $m = -1$ you get $E[A - B] = E[A] - E[B]$, which is why $\bar{d} = \bar{x}_A - \bar{x}_B$ (Comp p.8).

HW0 Q4. Fair coin tossed 4 times. P(all heads), P(at least one tail), P(exactly 2H 2T)

Question. *A fair coin is tossed 4 times. (i) What is the probability that all four tosses will be "heads"? (ii) What is the probability that at least one toss will give "tail"? (iii) What is the probability that there will be exactly 2 heads and 2 tails? Show your work (i.e., explain how you obtained your answers).*

In plain words. With a fair coin every sequence of 4 tosses is equally likely. So each probability is the number of sequences you want divided by the total number of sequences. For "at least one" it's easier to count the opposite, no tails at all, and subtract from 1.

1. *Formula.* $P[\text{event}] = \dfrac{\text{sequences in the event}}{\text{all sequences}}$. All sequences $= 2^n$, where n is the number of tosses.
2. *Plug in.* $2^4 = 2 \times 2 \times 2 \times 2 = 16$ sequences.
3. All heads. Only HHHH, so 1 sequence. $P = 1/16 = 0.0625$.
4. At least one tail. *Formula.* $P[\text{at least one}] = 1 - P[\text{none}]$. *Plug in.* $1 - 1/16$. *Work it out.* $16/16 - 1/16 = 15/16$. *Result.* 0.9375.
5. Exactly 2 heads. *Formula.* $\text{count} = \binom{n}{k} = \dfrac{n!}{k!\,(n-k)!}$, the number of ways to choose which k of the n tosses are heads. *Plug in.* $\binom{4}{2} = \dfrac{4!}{2!\,2!}$. *Work it out.* $\dfrac{24}{2 \times 2} = 6$ sequences (HHTT, HTHT, HTTH, THHT, THTH, TTHH). *Result.* $6/16 = 3/8 = 0.375$.

Answer. $1/16 = 0.0625$, $15/16 = 0.9375$, $3/8 = 0.375$.

Usual mistake. Adding probabilities instead of using the complement for "at least one". The same coin is the error model on CI p.12. Two $\pm E$ sources give $x - 2E, x, x + 2E$ with $1/4, 1/2, 1/4$. With 3 sources, $P[x + E] = \binom{3}{2}/8 = 3/8$, and many sources turn the binomial into a normal (CI p.15).

HW0 Q5. Requests per ms with $P_0, P_1, P_2, P_4, P_5, P_6, P_7$ = .18, .22, .14, .18, .12, .10, .06. Type? Why is $P_7 = 0.09$ invalid? Mean, variance, SD, COV

Question. *On a certain server, the number of client requests per millisecond varies between 0 and 7, with the following probabilities (P_i is the probability that there are i requests per millisecond). $P_0 = 0.18$, $P_1 = 0.22$, $P_2 = 0.14$, $P_4 = 0.18$, $P_5 = 0.12$, $P_6 = 0.10$, $P_7 = 0.06$. (i) What type of probability distribution is this (discrete or continuous)? (ii) If P_7 was 0.09, this would not be a valid probability distribution. Why? (iii) Let X denote the random variable that shows the number of client requests per millisecond (i.e., $P_i = P(X = i)$). Find the mean, variance, standard deviation, coefficient of variation for X. Show your work.*

In plain words. You get a table of values and their chances. Discrete means it only takes separate values you can count, like 0, 1, 2 requests. The mean is each value times its chance, added up. Variance says how spread out it is, the SD is its square root, and COV is the SD divided by the mean, so it's the spread relative to the size.

1. Whole-number values only, so it's discrete.
2. Probabilities must add to exactly 1. Listed values give $.18 + .22 + .14 + .18 + .12 + .10 + .06 = 1.00$, so $P_3 = 0$. With $P_7 = 0.09$ the sum is $1.00 - 0.06 + 0.09 = 1.03 > 1$, so it's invalid.
3. Mean. *Formula.* $\mu = E[X] = \sum x\,p(x)$, where x is a number of requests and $p(x)$ its probability. *Plug in.* $0(.18) + 1(.22) + 2(.14) + 4(.18) + 5(.12) + 6(.10) + 7(.06)$. *Work it out.* $0 + 0.22 + 0.28 + 0.72 + 0.60 + 0.60 + 0.42$. *Result.* $\mu = 2.84$.
4. Average of squares. *Formula.* $E[X^2] = \sum x^2\,p(x)$. *Plug in.* $0(.18) + 1(.22) + 4(.14) + 16(.18) + 25(.12) + 36(.10) + 49(.06)$. *Work it out.* $0 + 0.22 + 0.56 + 2.88 + 3.00 + 3.60 + 2.94$. *Result.* 13.20.
5. Variance. *Formula.* $\text{Var} = E[X^2] - \mu^2$, the average of the squares minus the square of the average. *Plug in.* $13.20 - 2.84^2$. *Work it out.* $2.84^2 = 8.0656$, so $13.20 - 8.0656$. *Result.* 5.1344.
6. SD. *Formula.* $\sigma = \sqrt{\text{Var}}$. *Plug in.* $\sqrt{5.1344}$. *Result.* 2.266.
7. COV. *Formula.* $\text{COV} = \sigma/\mu$ (Summ p.41). *Plug in.* $2.266/2.84$. *Result.* 0.798.

Answer. Discrete, mean 2.84, variance 5.134, SD 2.27, COV 0.80.

Usual mistake. Dividing by $n - 1$ here. These are known probabilities of a population, so there's no $n - 1$. Also forgetting the missing P_3 and putting P_4's value at $x = 3$.

Small version. $X \in \{0, 1, 2\}$ with $.25, .5, .25$. $E[X] = 0(.25) + 1(.5) + 2(.25) = 0 + 0.5 + 0.5 = 1$. $E[X^2] = 0(.25) + 1(.5) + 4(.25) = 0 + 0.5 + 1 = 1.5$. $\text{Var} = 1.5 - 1^2 = 0.5$, $\text{SD} = \sqrt{0.5} = 0.707$, $\text{COV} = 0.707/1 = 0.707$. COV is meaningless if the mean is 0 or negative (Summ p.41).

HW0 Q6. Cohort with Spring 10 (6 BS, 4 MS) and Fall 30 (17 BS, 13 MS). P(Fall), P(MS), P(Spring|MS), P(Fall|BS)

Question. *The 2019 PhD CS cohort has the following student profiles. Spring 2019 Start Term, 10 students started. 6 have only BS degree, 4 have MS degrees. Fall 2019 Start Term, 30 students started. 17 have only BS degree, 13 have MS degrees. If a random student is selected from the 2019 cohort, (i) What is the probability that the student started in Fall 2019? (ii) What is the probability that the student has MS degree? (iii) If we randomly select a student and the student has MS degree, what is the probability that the student started in Spring'19? (iv) If we randomly select a student and the student has only BS degree, what is the probability that the student started in Fall'19?*

In plain words. This is counting from a table. A plain probability divides by all 40 students. A conditional one, written $P[A \mid B]$ and read "A given B", only looks at the students in group B, because you already know the student is in B.

1. Totals. Students $= 10 + 30 = 40$. MS $= 4 + 13 = 17$. BS-only $= 6 + 17 = 23$.
2. P[Fall]. *Formula.* $P[A] = \dfrac{\text{students in } A}{\text{all students}}$. *Plug in.* 30/40. *Result.* 0.75.
3. P[MS]. *Plug in.* 17/40. *Result.* 0.425.
4. P[Spring | MS]. *Formula.* $P[A \mid B] = \dfrac{P[A \text{ and } B]}{P[B]}$, the chance of A once you know B happened. Here A is started in Spring and B is holds an MS. *Plug in.* P[Spring and MS] = 4/40 (4 of the 40 are Spring MS) and P[MS] = 17/40, so $\dfrac{4/40}{17/40}$. *Work it out.* The /40 cancels, leaving 4/17. *Result.* 0.235. Shortcut, just count inside the MS group, 4 of 17.
5. P[Fall | BS]. *Plug in.* P[Fall and BS] = 17/40, P[BS] = 23/40, so $\dfrac{17/40}{23/40}$. *Work it out.* 17/23. *Result.* 0.739.

Answer. 0.75, 0.425, 0.235, 0.739.

Usual mistake. Dividing by the wrong total, for example 4/10,

which is $P[\text{MS} \mid \text{Spring}]$. The same direction mix-up is the p-value trap, since $P[\text{data} \mid H_0] \neq P[H_0 \mid \text{data}]$ (HT p.13 to 14).

HW0 Q7. $X \sim U(10, 90)$**. Mean, SD,** $P[X < 20]$**,** $P[X > 60]$**,** $P[20 < X < 30]$

Question. *Assume a random variable has uniform distribution between 10 and 90. What is the mean? What is the standard deviation? What is the probability that the random variable will take a value (i) less than 20? (ii) more than 60? (iii) between 20 and 30?*

In plain words. Uniform means every value between 10 and 90 is equally likely, so the density is a flat line. Any probability is just the length of the stretch you care about divided by the full length, 80. The mean is the middle, and the SD has a fixed formula.

1. Mean. *Formula.* $\mu = (a+b)/2$, where $a = 10$ is the low end and $b = 90$ the high end. *Plug in.* $(10 + 90)/2$. *Work it out.* $100/2$. *Result.* 50.
2. Variance. *Formula.* $\sigma^2 = (b-a)^2/12$. *Plug in.* $(90-10)^2/12$. *Work it out.* $80^2 = 6400$, then $6400/12$. *Result.* 533.3.
3. SD. *Formula.* $\sigma = \sqrt{\sigma^2} = (b-a)/\sqrt{12}$. *Plug in.* $80/\sqrt{12}$. *Work it out.* $80/3.464$. *Result.* 23.09.
4. Probabilities. *Formula.* $P[c < X < d] = \dfrac{d-c}{b-a}$, length of the stretch over 80.
5. $P[X < 20]$. *Plug in.* $(20-10)/80$. *Work it out.* $10/80$. *Result.* 0.125.
6. $P[X > 60]$. *Plug in.* $(90-60)/80$. *Work it out.* $30/80$. *Result.* 0.375.
7. $P[20 < X < 30]$. *Plug in.* $(30-20)/80$. *Work it out.* $10/80$. *Result.* 0.125.

Answer. Mean 50, SD 23.09, then 0.125, 0.375, 0.125.

Usual mistake. Using $(b-a)/12$ or forgetting the square. Rounding error of a timer is uniform on $\pm\Delta$, so its SD is $2\Delta/\sqrt{12}$ (quantization, CI p.9 to 10).

HW0 Q8. $Z \sim N(0, 1)$**.** $P[0.9 < Z < 1.3]$**,** $P[Z > 0.9]$**,** $P[Z > -0.9]$

Question. *Assume a random variable has standard normal distribution $N(0, 1)$. What is the probability that this random variable will take on a value (i) between 0.9 and 1.3, (ii) greater than 0.9, (iii) greater than -0.9? Explain how you obtained your results.*

In plain words. Z is the standard bell curve with mean 0 and SD 1. The table gives $\Phi(z)$, the area to the left of z, which is the chance of landing below z. Every question is a left area, a right area (1 minus the left area), or the gap between two left areas.

1. Between. *Formula.* $P[a < Z < b] = \Phi(b) - \Phi(a)$. *Plug in.* $\Phi(1.3) - \Phi(0.9)$. *Work it out.* $0.9032 - 0.8159$. *Result.* 0.0873.
2. Above. *Formula.* $P[Z > a] = 1 - \Phi(a)$. *Plug in.* $1 - \Phi(0.9)$. *Work it out.* $1 - 0.8159$. *Result.* 0.1841.
3. Above a negative. *Formula.* Symmetry gives $\Phi(-a) = 1 - \Phi(a)$. *Plug in.* $P[Z > -0.9] = 1 - \Phi(-0.9) = 1 - (1 - \Phi(0.9))$. *Work it out.* That's just $\Phi(0.9)$. *Result.* 0.8159.

Answer. 0.0873, 0.1841, 0.8159.

Usual mistake. Answering $P[Z > -0.9]$ with 0.1841. Sketch the curve and shade before subtracting.

HW0 Q9. Highs $\sim N(85, 6^2)$**.** $P[83 < X < 88]$**,** $P[X > 90]$**,** $P[X < 82]$ **with z-scores**

Question. *Over the course of several years, in a certain city, it is observed that the highest daily temperature in August, in Fahrenheit, is normally distributed with mean = 85 and standard deviation = 6. What is the probability that a randomly selected August day's highest temperature is (i) between 83 and 88, (ii) greater than 90, (iii) smaller than 82? Solve problem 9 using z scores. Show your work.*

In plain words. Turn each temperature into a z-score, which counts how many SDs it sits away from the mean. Then it's a standard normal question and you use the same table as Q8.

1. *Formula.* $z = (x - \mu)/\sigma$, where x is the temperature, $\mu = 85$ the mean and $\sigma = 6$ the SD.
2. Between 83 and 88. *Plug in.* $z_1 = (83 - 85)/6 = -2/6 = -0.33$ and $z_2 = (88 - 85)/6 = 3/6 = 0.5$. *Work it out.* $\Phi(0.5) - \Phi(-0.33) = 0.6915 - (1 - 0.6293) = 0.6915 - 0.3707$. *Result.* 0.3208.
3. Above 90. *Plug in.* $z = (90 - 85)/6 = 5/6 = 0.83$. *Work it out.* $1 - \Phi(0.83) = 1 - 0.7967$. *Result.* 0.2033.
4. Below 82. *Plug in.* $z = (82 - 85)/6 = -3/6 = -0.5$. *Work it out.* $\Phi(-0.5) = 1 - \Phi(0.5) = 1 - 0.6915$. *Result.* 0.3085.

Answer. About 0.321, 0.203, 0.309 (unrounded z gives 0.322 and 0.202).

Backwards version. Where do the hottest 5% of days start? *Formula.* $x = \mu + z\sigma$. *Plug in.* $85 + z[0.05] \times 6 = 85 + 1.645 \times 6$. *Work it out.* $1.645 \times 6 = 9.87$, so $85 + 9.87$. *Result.* 94.9.

HW2. Beyond performance metrics (report)

HW2. Pick metrics from your area, evaluate them on the lecture's criteria, propose extra criteria (Metrics p.33)

Question. *HW 2, Beyond Performance Metrics. (i) Identify one or more metrics commonly used in your area of research. If you haven't yet decided on your research area, pick one of the areas you might be interested in. Look at one or more seminal research articles in your area and see what metrics were used. (ii) Evaluate the metric(s) based on the criteria discussed in today's lecture. What additional criteria might be useful in evaluating metrics in your research area? (iii) Submit a short typed report (at most 4 pages), using LaTeX.*

In plain words. Pick the numbers people in your research area use to say "my system is better", then grade each one against the six properties a good metric should have. The key idea is that a metric can be easy to measure and still mislead, like MIPS. It's graded on argument, so every yes or no needs a concrete example of how the metric fails.

1. List the six criteria (Metrics p.7 to 12). Linear (2x metric means 2x performance). Reliable (A scores higher means A really is better). Repeatable (same experiment, same value). Easy to use (easy to measure correctly). Consistent (same units and definition on every system). Independent (vendors can't bend it).
2. Say which are required. Reliable, repeatable, consistent and independent are required, while linear and easy to use are nice to have (Metrics p.13).
3. Classify means versus ends. Means-based counts what was done, useful or not. Ends-based counts what got accomplished (Metrics p.27 to 28).
4. For each metric, give a verdict per criterion with one concrete failure.
5. Propose extra criteria your area needs.

His answer. Area is low-latency video streaming. Metrics were average throughput and the QoE score (Yin et al. 2015, chunk

quality minus a switch penalty minus a stall penalty, as a weighted sum).

Criterion	Throughput	QoE score
Linear	Yes	No
Reliable	No	No
Repeatable	Partly	Partly
Easy to use	Yes	Yes
Consistent	Partly	No
Independent	No	No

- Throughput isn't reliable because a sender can inflate it by filling a deep queue (bufferbloat), the same failure as MIPS (Metrics p.17). It isn't independent because ISPs advertise it. Repeatability is partial because Pantheon found algorithm rankings change with the path. It's a means metric used for ends claims, since 8 Mbps with two stalls beats 5 Mbps with none.
- QoE isn't consistent because each paper picks its own weights (Yin's stall weight 3000, Pensieve's three variants), the MFLOPS problem. It isn't linear since it adds unlike units. It isn't reliable because the linear form was never validated against subjective tests (Peroni and Gorinsky 2024). It isn't independent because authors set the weights they're judged under.
- Extra criteria. Externality, meaning what a flow does to others on the link, which Jain's index hides. Report the distribution and the tail, not just the mean. State the conditions the metric was checked over.

By hand, Jain's index. *Formula.* $J = \dfrac{(\sum x_i)^2}{n \sum x_i^2}$, where x_i is flow i's throughput and n the number of flows. It's 1 when all flows get the same and $1/n$ when one flow gets everything. *Plug in.* Flows of 90 and 10 Mbps, $n = 2$, so $\dfrac{(90+10)^2}{2(90^2+10^2)}$. *Work it out.* $\dfrac{100^2}{2(8100+100)} = \dfrac{10000}{16400}$. *Result.* 0.61.

By hand, precision and recall (Metrics p.32). *Formula.* Precision $= \dfrac{\text{relevant retrieved}}{\text{all retrieved}}$ and recall $= \dfrac{\text{relevant retrieved}}{\text{all relevant}}$. *Plug in.* 30 retrieved, 20 of them relevant, 40 relevant ones missed. Precision $= 20/30$, recall $= 20/(20+40) = 20/60$. *Result.* Precision 0.67, recall 0.33.

Check. The repeatability paragraph says Puffer's 95% CI on stall ratio was "around 10 to 17 percent of the mean" after "1.75 years" per scheme. Those numbers are from the arXiv preprint. The NSDI 2020 version he cites (and quotes in HW4) says ±13% to ±21% with at least 2.5 years per scheme. The argument stands, but the two homeworks quote different versions.

Usual mistake. Saying a metric "fails" without naming the failure. On the exam, MIPS is repeatable, easy and independent but not linear, reliable or consistent (Metrics p.17).

How to write it on the exam.

1. Name the metric and what it counts, then say means or ends.
2. Go down the six criteria in order, one line each, with a yes, no or partly and a concrete reason.
3. Flag which failures matter most, the required four (Metrics p.13).
4. Add one criterion your area needs and say why the six miss it.

Exam variant, MIPS. *Formula.* MIPS $= \dfrac{n}{T_e \times 10^6}$ (Metrics p.16), where n is the number of instructions run and T_e the run time in seconds. *Plug in.* A CISC machine runs 50M instructions in 1 s, so $\dfrac{50 \times 10^6}{1 \times 10^6} = 50$. A RISC machine runs 100M simpler instructions for the same program in 0.8 s, so $\dfrac{100 \times 10^6}{0.8 \times 10^6} = 125$. *Work it out.* MIPS ratio $125/50 = 2.5$. Real speedup is old time over new time, $1/0.8 = 1.25$. *Result.* MIPS ranks RISC 2.5x better, but it's really 1.25x faster. So MIPS isn't linear, and with different instruction sets it isn't consistent either. Execution time is the ends-based alternative (Metrics p.27 to 28).

HW3. Choosing a mean, quartiles, histograms, Q-Q plots

HW3 Q1a. Five stacked features improve quality 10, 50, 70, 85, 15%. Mean improvement per feature, and which mean?

Question. *Q1 (3 pts). For each of the following sub-questions, i) indicate what type of mean (arithmetic, geometric, or harmonic) should be used, with explanation, ii) Compute the mean value based on your choice. a. A researcher considers adding five new features to her optimization project to improve the quality of the solution. Each feature is implemented on top of the previous one (i.e., Feature 2 is implemented on top of Feature 1, Feature 3 is implemented on top of Feature 2, and so on.) She observes the following quality improvements after adding each feature. Feature 1, 10%. Feature 2, 50%. Feature 3, 70%. Feature 4, 85%. Feature 5, 15%. What is the mean improvement per feature? What type of mean did you use and why?*

In plain words. The mean you pick depends on how the numbers combine. Here each feature's gain stacks on top of the previous one, so the gains multiply instead of adding. The geometric mean is the one number that, multiplied by itself 5 times, gives the same total gain as the real five.

1. Each feature builds on the last, so effects multiply. Use the geometric mean (Summ p.30, p.32).
2. *Formula.* GM $= (x_1 x_2 \cdots x_n)^{1/n}$, where $x_i = 1 + \text{gain}_i$ is the ratio new over old and $n = 5$ features (Summ p.23).
3. *Plug in.* Ratios 1.10, 1.50, 1.70, 1.85, 1.15, so GM $= (1.10 \times 1.50 \times 1.70 \times 1.85 \times 1.15)^{1/5}$.
4. *Work it out.* $1.10 \times 1.50 = 1.65$, $\times 1.70 = 2.805$, $\times 1.85 = 5.18925$, $\times 1.15 = 5.9676$. Fifth root by hand with logs, $\ln 5.9676 = 1.786$, $1.786/5 = 0.357$, $e^{0.357} = 1.4294$.
5. *Result.* GM $= 1.4294$. Subtract 1 to get back to a percentage, $0.4294 = 42.94\%$.

Answer. Geometric mean, because the gains compound. 1.4294, so 42.94% per feature. Matches his main.tex.

Usual mistake. Taking the GM of the percentages (10, 50, ...) instead of the ratios, or forgetting to subtract 1 at the end.

By hand. Gains of 100, 300, 700% are ratios 2, 4, 8. *Plug in.* GM $= (2 \times 4 \times 8)^{1/3}$. *Work it out.* $2 \times 4 \times 8 = 64$ and $\sqrt[3]{64} = 4$. *Result.* $4 - 1 = 3$, so 300% per version. The AM of the ratios, $(2+4+8)/3 = 4.67$, would compound to $4.67^3 \approx 102$, not 64.

HW3 Q1b. Compiler times 150, 200, 120, 300, 270, 180 ms. Mean, and which?

Question. *b. The running time of a new compiler is measured with source programs of comparable size. In 6 experiments, the running times are measured as 150 ms, 200 ms, 120 ms, 300 ms, 270 ms, and 180 ms. What is the mean execution time? What type of mean did you use and why?*

In plain words. These are running times, and times add up into a total. The arithmetic mean, the usual sum divided by count, is the one whose total matches the real total time, so it's the right one.

1. These are times, so the mean should be proportional to total time. Arithmetic mean (Summ p.25, p.27).
2. *Formula.* $\bar{x} = \dfrac{1}{n} \sum x_i$, where x_i are the times and $n = 6$ runs.

3. *Plug in.* $\dfrac{150+200+120+300+270+180}{6}$.
4. *Work it out.* $150+200=350$, $+120=470$, $+300=770$, $+270=1040$, $+180=1220$. Then $1220/6$.
5. *Result.* 203.33 ms.

Answer. Arithmetic mean, because times add up to a total. 203.33 ms.

Usual mistake. Using the harmonic mean because it's "performance". Times take the AM.

Weighted version (Summ p.33). *Formula.* $\bar{x}_w = \sum w_i x_i$ with weights w_i adding to 1. *Plug in.* Times 2, 5, 10 s with weights .5, .3, .2 give $.5(2)+.3(5)+.2(10)$. *Work it out.* $1+1.5+2$. *Result.* 4.5 s.

HW3 Q1c. DB at 2500, 3500, 3700, 1800, 2000 tps. Mean, and which?

Question. *c. A new database system is implemented and its performance is tested. In five different experiments, the following performance (speed) values are obtained. 2500 transactions per second, 3500 transactions per second, 3700 transactions per second, 1800 transactions per second, 2000 transactions per second. What is the mean performance (in terms of transactions per second)? What type of mean did you use and why?*

In plain words. These are rates, things per second, and you can't just average rates. If every run did the same amount of work, the honest average rate is total work over total time, and that works out to the harmonic mean, n divided by the sum of the $1/x_i$.

1. Rates have time in the denominator, so the mean should be inversely proportional to total time. Harmonic (Summ p.25, p.28).
2. *Formula.* $x_H = \dfrac{n}{\sum 1/x_i}$ (Summ p.22), where x_i are the rates and $n=5$ runs.
3. *Plug in.* $x_H = \dfrac{5}{1/2500+1/3500+1/3700+1/1800+1/2000}$.
4. *Work it out.* The reciprocals are $0.000400+0.000286+0.000270+0.000556+0.000500=0.0020115$. Then $5/0.0020115$.
5. *Result.* $x_H = 2485.66$ tps.

Answer. Harmonic mean, because these are rates with equal work per run. 2485.66 tps.

Usual mistake. The AM of rates, $(2500+3500+3700+1800+2000)/5 = 13500/5 = 2700$, overstates. The HM is right only if every run did the same work F (Summ p.28).

By hand. Rates 2, 3, 6. *Plug in.* $x_H = \dfrac{3}{1/2+1/3+1/6}$. *Work it out.* $1/2+1/3+1/6 = 3/6+2/6+1/6 = 6/6 = 1$, so $3/1$. *Result.* $x_H = 3$. The AM would say $11/3 = 3.67$.

Exam variant, unequal work. Program 1 does 100 Mops at 50 Mops/s, program 2 does 300 Mops at 100 Mops/s. *Formula.* True rate $= \dfrac{\text{total work}}{\text{total time}}$, with time = work over rate. *Plug in.* Times $100/50 = 2$ s and $300/100 = 3$ s, so rate $= \dfrac{100+300}{2+3}$. *Work it out.* $400/5$. *Result.* 80 Mops/s. The plain HM gives $2/(1/50+1/100) = 2/0.03 = 66.7$, which is wrong because it assumes equal work per run (Summ p.26, p.28).

HW3 Q2a,b. For normal.txt ($n=1000$) and not-normal.txt ($n=870$), mean, variance, median, Q1, Q2, Q3

Question. *Q2. Consider the two data sets, normal.txt and not-normal.txt. For each data set, do the following exercises. a. (0.5 pts) Find the mean and variance of the sample data. b. (0.5 pts) Find the median, first, second, and third quartile of the sample data. Note, you can use a program such as Microsoft Excel/OpenOffice Calc/Matlab/Mathematica/etc. for doing these exercises, or you can do them without the help of any program.* [The files hold 1000 and 870 values.]

In plain words. Summarize each data set by its center (mean and median) and its spread (variance and quartiles). Quartiles are the values that cut the sorted data into four equal parts. The course has a fixed recipe for where each sorted value sits, $(i-0.5)/n$, and you interpolate between neighbours when a quartile falls between two values.

1. Mean. *Formula.* $\bar{x} = \frac{1}{n}\sum x_i$, where x_i are the data values and n the count. *Plug in.* normal has $\sum x = 2014.15$, so $2014.15/1000$. not-normal has $\sum x = 181.25$, so $181.25/870$. *Result.* 2.0142 and 0.2083.
2. Variance. *Formula.* Sample variance with $n-1$, one-pass form $s^2 = \dfrac{\sum x_i^2 - (\sum x_i)^2/n}{n-1}$ (Summ p.39). *Plug in.* normal has $\sum x^2 = 5101.51$, so $\dfrac{5101.51 - 2014.15^2/1000}{999}$. *Work it out.* $2014.15^2/1000 = 4056.82$, $5101.51 - 4056.82 = 1044.69$, then $1044.69/999$. *Result.* 1.0457. not-normal, $\dfrac{76.01 - 181.25^2/870}{869} = \dfrac{76.01-37.76}{869} = \dfrac{38.25}{869} = 0.0440$.
3. Quartiles. *Formula.* Sort the data. The i-th smallest value $x_{(i)}$ sits at fraction $f_i = (i-0.5)/n$. Solving for the position of quantile p gives $i = pn + 0.5$ (Summ p.59). If i isn't a whole number, go that far between the two neighbours.
4. normal ($n=1000$). Q_1 at $i = 0.25(1000)+0.5 = 250.5$, halfway between $x_{(250)} = 1.2646$ and $x_{(251)} = 1.2714$, so 1.2680. Median at $i = 500.5$, halfway between 2.0320 and 2.0324, so 2.0322. Q_3 at $i = 750.5$, halfway between 2.6905 and 2.6948, so 2.6927.
5. not-normal ($n=870$). Q_1 at $i = 0.25(870)+0.5 = 218$, exactly $x_{(218)} = 0.0587$. Median at $i = 435.5$, halfway between 0.1426 and 0.1432, so 0.1429. Q_3 at $i = 653$, exactly $x_{(653)} = 0.2865$.

Answer.

	normal	not-normal
Mean	2.0142	0.2083
Variance ($n-1$)	1.0457	0.0440
Min	−1.6554	0.0007
Q_1	1.2680	0.0587
Median $= Q_2$	2.0322	0.1429
Q_3	2.6927	0.2865
Max	5.2128	1.2957

not-normal is right-skewed. The mean 0.208 sits above the median 0.143, and $Q_3 - Q_2 = 0.2865 - 0.1429 = 0.144$ against $Q_2 - Q_1 = 0.1429 - 0.0587 = 0.084$ (Summ p.48). For skewed data report the SIQR. *Formula.* SIQR $= (Q_3 - Q_1)/2$, half the width of the middle 50%. *Plug in.* $(0.2865 - 0.0587)/2$. *Work it out.* 0.2278/2. *Result.* 0.114 (Summ p.45, p.49).

By hand. Data 7, 1, 11, 5, 9, 3. Sorted 1, 3, 5, 7, 9, 11.

1. Mean. $\bar{x} = (1+3+5+7+9+11)/6 = 36/6 = 6$.
2. Variance. $\sum x^2 = 1+9+25+49+81+121 = 286$. $(\sum x)^2/n = 36^2/6 = 1296/6 = 216$. $s^2 = (286-216)/5 = 70/5 = 14$, so $s = \sqrt{14} = 3.742$.
3. Quartiles. The f_i are .083, .25, .417, .583, .75, .917. Q_1 at $i = 0.25(6)+0.5 = 2$, so $x_{(2)} = 3$. Q_3 at $i = 0.75(6)+0.5 = 5$, so $x_{(5)} = 9$. Median at $i = 3.5$, halfway between 5 and 7, so 6. With $n=10$, Q_1 at $i=3$ and Q_3 at $i=8$ exactly.

Exam variant with interpolation. Data 2, 4, 4, 5, 7, 9, 10, 12 ($n = 8$). The f_i are .0625, .1875, .3125, .4375, .5625, .6875, .8125, .9375. Q_1 at $i = 0.25(8) + 0.5 = 2.5$, between $x_{(2)} = 4$ and $x_{(3)} = 4$, so 4. Median at $i = 4.5$, halfway between 5 and 7, so 6. Q_3 at $i = 6.5$, halfway between $x_{(6)} = 9$ and $x_{(7)} = 10$, so 9.5. SIQR $= (9.5 - 4)/2 = 5.5/2 = 2.75$.

Usual mistake. Dividing by n for a sample variance, or taking Q_1 as $x_{(n/4)}$ without the $(i - 0.5)/n$ positions.

HW3 Q2c. Histogram of each

Question. *c. (1 pts) Plot the sample data using a histogram.* [For each of normal.txt and not-normal.txt.]

In plain words. A histogram chops the range into equal-width bins and counts how many values land in each, so you can see the shape of the data. The only real decision is how many bins, and Sturges' rule gives a default from n.

1. Equal-width bins over the range, plot relative frequency (Summ p.54).
2. Number of bins. *Formula.* Sturges, $k = \lfloor 1 + \log_2 n \rfloor$ (Summ p.54), where k is the bin count and n the number of values. *Plug in.* $1 + \log_2 1000 = 1 + 9.97 = 10.97$ and $1 + \log_2 870 = 1 + 9.76 = 10.76$. *Work it out.* Round down. *Result.* $k = 10$ for both.
3. Bin width. *Formula.* width $= (\max - \min)/k$. *Plug in.* normal $(5.2128 - (-1.6554))/10$, not-normal $(1.2957 - 0.0007)/10$. *Work it out.* 6.868/10 and 1.295/10. *Result.* 0.687 and 0.130.
4. Counts with 10 bins. normal gives 1, 6, 54, 128, 214, 258, 217, 83, 33, 6. not-normal gives 402, 228, 94, 69, 33, 20, 12, 6, 2, 4.

Answer. normal.txt is a symmetric bell with its peak in the bin around 1.8 to 2.5, close to the mean 2.01. not-normal.txt piles up in the first bin near 0 and trails off in a long right tail out to about 1.3. So one looks normal and the other is right-skewed.

Check. His main.tex says 11 bins for both because analyze.py used round$(1 + \log_2 n)$, which rounds 10.97 and 10.76 up. The slide floors, giving 10. No conclusion changes, but use the floor on the exam.

By hand. Six points 1, 3, 5, 7, 9, 11. $k = \lfloor 1 + \log_2 6 \rfloor = \lfloor 1 + 2.58 \rfloor = 3$. Width $= (11 - 1)/3 = 3.33$. Bins $[1, 4.33)$, $[4.33, 7.67)$, $[7.67, 11]$ hold 2, 2, 2. Bin width changes the shape (Summ p.55 to 56), so judge shape with the Q-Q plot.

HW3 Q2d. Quantile plot

Question. *d. (2 pts) Draw the quantile plot for the sample data.* [For each of normal.txt and not-normal.txt.]

In plain words. A quantile plot is just the sorted data plotted against where each point sits, its fraction f_i. You can read any percentile straight off it, and the shape shows the tails. A long flat stretch then a sharp climb means a long right tail.

1. Plot $(f_i, x_{(i)})$ with $f_i = (i - 0.5)/n$, where $x_{(i)}$ is the i-th smallest value (Summ p.59).
2. normal.txt gives an S shape. not-normal.txt stays flat, then shoots up near $f = 1$, the long right tail.

Answer. The S shape for normal.txt and the flat-then-steep curve for not-normal.txt in step 2.

By hand. In the Summ p.60 table ($n = 10$), $Q(0.80)$ sits at $i = 0.80(10) + 0.5 = 8.5$, halfway between $x_{(8)} = 44.5$ and $x_{(9)} = 50.3$. *Work it out.* $(44.5 + 50.3)/2 = 94.8/2$. *Result.* 47.4.

HW3 Q2e. Compare with a normal using a Q-Q plot

Question. *e. (3 pts) Compare the distribution of the sample data against the theoretical normal distribution using a Q-Q plot.* [For each of normal.txt and not-normal.txt.]

In plain words. A Q-Q plot lines up your sorted data against what a perfect normal with the same mean and SD would give at the same positions. If the data are normal, the points fall on a straight line. Bends at the ends tell you which way the data aren't normal.

1. For each f_i find z_i with $\Phi(z_i) = f_i$, where z_i is the standard normal value with area f_i below it. Use the table or $z_i = 4.91[f_i^{0.14} - (1 - f_i)^{0.14}]$ (Summ p.69).
2. *Formula.* Rescale $x_i = m + sz_i$, where m is the sample mean and s the sample SD, so normal data falls on the 45° line. Unscaled, the intercept is the mean and the slope the SD (Summ p.70).
3. Plot theoretical against observed (Summ p.63) and read the shape (Summ p.71 to 73).

Answer. normal.txt follows the line with correlation 0.9993, so it's consistent with normal. not-normal.txt sits above the line at both ends and below in the middle, correlation 0.904. The normal predicts about -0.47 at the low end but the data never go below 0, and the top values are far too large. Right-skewed, not normal.

By hand. Data 1, 3, 5, 7, 9, 11 with $m = 6$, $s = 3.742$.

1. f_i for $i = 1, 2, 3$ are $0.5/6 = .083$, $1.5/6 = .25$, $2.5/6 = .417$. From the table $z = -1.38, -0.67, -0.21$, and the top three are the same with a plus sign.
2. *Plug in.* $x = 6 + 3.742z$. *Work it out.* $6 - 3.742(1.38) = 6 - 5.16 = 0.84$, $6 - 3.742(0.67) = 6 - 2.51 = 3.49$, $6 - 3.742(0.21) = 6 - 0.79 = 5.21$, then by symmetry 6.79, 8.51, 11.16.
3. *Result.* Pairs (0.84, 1), (3.49, 3) and so on are all within 0.5 of the line, so normal.

Skewed version 1, 1, 1, 2, 3, 10. $m = 18/6 = 3$. Deviations $-2, -2, -2, -1, 0, 7$, squares sum to $4 + 4 + 4 + 1 + 0 + 49 = 62$, $s^2 = 62/5 = 12.4$, $s = 3.52$. Theoretical $3 - 3.52(1.38) = -1.86$, $3 - 3.52(0.67) = 0.64$, $3 - 3.52(0.21) = 2.26$, then 3.74, 5.36, 7.86. Ends above the line and middle below is the right-skew pattern.

Usual mistake. Plotting f_i instead of z_i on the x-axis, or reading "longer tails" (Summ p.71) when the shape is asymmetric (Summ p.73).

HW4. Confidence intervals

HW4 1.1 and 2.1. The file is the population. Population mean and variance

Question. *State which tool you used (Excel, Python, R) for each part. Problem 1, Normally distributed data. Use the population data in the file normal.txt. This data is normally distributed. 1. Find the population mean and variance. Problem 2, Data that is not normally distributed. Repeat parts 1 to 3 of Problem 1 for the population data in the file not-normal.txt. This data is not normally distributed.*

In plain words. The homework pretends the whole file is the entire population, so you know the true answer. Later you check whether your sample-based intervals actually caught it. For a whole population you divide by N, the number of values, not $N - 1$.

1. Mean. *Formula.* $\mu = \frac{1}{N}\sum x_i$, where N is the population size. *Plug in.* 2014.15/1000 and 181.25/870. *Result.* 2.0142 and 0.2083.
2. Variance. *Formula.* $\sigma^2 = \dfrac{\sum x_i^2 - (\sum x_i)^2/N}{N}$. Divide by N, not $N - 1$. The $n - 1$ is for estimating from a sample (Summ p.39).

Plug in. normal, 1044.69/1000. not-normal, 38.25/870. *Result.* 1.0447 and 0.0440.

3. Shortcut from HW3's value. $\sigma^2 = s^2 \times (N-1)/N = 1.0457 \times 999/1000 = 1.0447$.

Answer. normal has $\mu = 2.0142$, $\sigma^2 = 1.0447$. not-normal has $\mu = 0.2083$, $\sigma^2 = 0.0440$ (the same values as CI p.32).

HW4 1.2. Sample of 50 from normal.txt. 90, 95, 99% CIs. Do they contain μ?

Question. *2. Generate a random sample of size 50, that is, randomly select 50 numbers from the population. Find 90%, 95% and 99% confidence intervals for the mean. Is the population mean within the intervals?*

In plain words. A confidence interval is a range built from one sample that should catch the true mean most of the time. It's the sample mean plus or minus a margin. The margin is a critical value (bigger for more confidence) times the standard error $s/\sqrt{n}$, which is how much the sample mean would wobble if you redrew the sample.

1. $n > 30$, so use z (CI p.27, p.31). *Formula.* $\bar{x} \pm z[\alpha/2]\, s/\sqrt{n}$, where $\bar{x}$ is the sample mean, s the sample SD, n the sample size, and $z[\alpha/2]$ the normal value with area $\alpha/2$ above it. α is 1 minus the confidence, so 0.10, 0.05, 0.01.
2. From the sample, $\bar{x} = 2.2093$ and $s = 0.9443$.
3. SE. *Formula.* $\text{SE} = s/\sqrt{n}$. *Plug in.* $0.9443/\sqrt{50}$. *Work it out.* 0.9443/7.071. *Result.* 0.1335.
4. Margins. *Formula.* margin $= z[\alpha/2] \times \text{SE}$. *Plug in.* 1.645(0.1335), 1.960(0.1335), 2.576(0.1335). *Result.* 0.2196, 0.2617, 0.3439.
5. CIs. *Plug in.* 2.2093 ± 0.2196, 2.2093 ± 0.2617, 2.2093 ± 0.3439. *Result.* below.

Answer. 90% (1.9897, 2.4290), 95% (1.9476, 2.4710), 99% (1.8653, 2.5533). All contain $\mu = 2.0142$.

By hand. $n = 100$, $\bar{x} = 10$, $s = 2$. $\text{SE} = 2/\sqrt{100} = 2/10 = 0.2$. Margin $1.96 \times 0.2 = 0.392$. CI $10 \pm 0.392 = (9.61, 10.39)$.

Sample size for $\pm 5\%$ at 95% (CI p.44). *Formula.* $n = \left(\dfrac{z\, s}{r\, \bar{x}}\right)^2$, where $r = 0.05$ is the allowed error as a fraction of the mean. *Plug in.* $\left(\dfrac{1.96 \times 2}{0.05 \times 10}\right)^2$. *Work it out.* $3.92/0.5 = 7.84$, $7.84^2 = 61.5$. *Result.* Round up to 62 runs.

HW4 1.3. Sample of 16. Same three CIs

Question. *3. Generate a random sample of size 16. Find 90%, 95% and 99% confidence intervals for the mean. Is the population mean within the intervals?*

In plain words. Same thing with only 16 points. With a small sample s itself is shaky, so you use the t distribution, which has fatter tails and gives a bigger critical value to pay for that. Its shape depends on the degrees of freedom (df), which is $n - 1$.

1. Small n and a normal population. *Formula.* $\bar{x} \pm t[\alpha/2, n-1]\, s/\sqrt{n}$, where $t[\alpha/2, n-1]$ is the t value with area $\alpha/2$ above it and $n-1$ df (CI p.37). Here df $= 16 - 1 = 15$.
2. From the sample, $\bar{x} = 2.2911$, $s = 1.1332$.
3. SE. *Plug in.* $1.1332/\sqrt{16}$. *Work it out.* 1.1332/4. *Result.* 0.2833.
4. Margins. *Plug in.* 1.753(0.2833), 2.131(0.2833), 2.947(0.2833). *Result.* 0.4966, 0.6037, 0.8349.
5. CIs. *Plug in.* 2.2911 ± 0.4966, 2.2911 ± 0.6037, 2.2911 ± 0.8349.

Answer. 90% (1.7944, 2.7877), 95% (1.6872, 2.8949), 99% (1.4562, 3.1259). All contain $\mu = 2.0142$.

By hand. $n = 9$, $\bar{x} = 20$, $s = 6$. $\text{SE} = 6/\sqrt{9} = 6/3 = 2$. df $= 8$, $t[0.025, 8] = 2.306$. Margin $2.306 \times 2 = 4.612$. CI $20 \pm 4.612 = (15.39, 24.61)$. If σ is given, use z even for small n (CI p.27).

Exam variant from raw values. Data 8, 10, 12, 14.

1. Mean. $(8 + 10 + 12 + 14)/4 = 44/4 = 11$.
2. SD. *Formula.* $s^2 = \dfrac{\sum (x_i - \bar{x})^2}{n-1}$. *Plug in.* Deviations $-3, -1, 1, 3$, squares $9, 1, 1, 9$. *Work it out.* $20/3 = 6.67$, $s = \sqrt{6.67} = 2.582$.
3. SE. $2.582/\sqrt{4} = 2.582/2 = 1.291$.
4. CI. df $= 3$, $t[0.025, 3] = 3.182$. Margin $3.182 \times 1.291 = 4.11$. *Result.* $11 \pm 4.11 = (6.89, 15.11)$.

HW4 1.4. Compare widths from 1.2 and 1.3, explain with sample size and distribution

Question. *4. Compare the widths of the intervals from parts 2 and 3. Explain the difference in terms of both the sample size and the distribution you used for the critical value.*

In plain words. Why is the $n = 16$ interval so much wider? Width is critical value times $s/\sqrt{n}$, so three things can change it. Fewer points shrink $\sqrt{n}$, the t value is bigger than z, and the sample SD came out different just by luck.

1. *Formula.* Width $= 2 \times \text{crit} \times s/\sqrt{n}$.
2. *Plug in.* $n = 50$, $2 \times 1.960 \times 0.1335$. $n = 16$, $2 \times 2.131 \times 0.2833$. *Result.* 0.5235 and 1.2077 (unrounded).
3. Ratio. $1.2077/0.5235 = 2.31$.
4. Split the ratio into factors. Sample size $\sqrt{50/16} = \sqrt{3.125} = 1.77$ (CI p.39). Critical value $2.131/1.960 = 1.09$, from t having heavier tails (CI p.35). Luck in s, $1.1332/0.9443 = 1.20$.
5. Check, $1.77 \times 1.09 \times 1.20 = 2.31$.

Answer. The 95% interval at $n = 16$ is 2.31 times as wide as at $n = 50$. About 1.77x comes from the smaller sample, 1.09x from using t with 15 df instead of z, and 1.20x from the second sample happening to have a bigger SD.

Usual mistake. Blaming only n. The question asks for the critical value too. Halving a width takes 4 times the data.

HW4 2.2 and 2.3. Repeat with not-normal.txt

Question. *Problem 2. Repeat parts 1 to 3 of Problem 1 for the population data in the file not-normal.txt. This data is not normally distributed.* [So 2.2 is a sample of 50 and 2.3 a sample of 16, each with 90%, 95% and 99% CIs for the mean, and is the population mean within the intervals?]

In plain words. Same intervals, but on skewed data. The point is to see whether the normal-based recipes still work when the data aren't normal. At $n = 50$ the central limit theorem (CLT), which says averages of many values look normal even when the values don't, saves you. At $n = 16$ it's shakier.

1. $n = 50$. The data aren't normal but the CLT makes $\bar{x}$ close to normal, so z is fine (CI p.29, p.67). $\bar{x} = 0.2168$, $s = 0.2278$. $\text{SE} = 0.2278/\sqrt{50} = 0.2278/7.071 = 0.0322$. Margins $1.645(0.0322) = 0.0530$, $1.960(0.0322) = 0.0631$, $2.576(0.0322) = 0.0829$. CIs are 0.2168 plus or minus each.
2. $n = 16$, t with 15 df. $\bar{x} = 0.2406$, $s = 0.2040$. $\text{SE} = 0.2040/\sqrt{16} = 0.2040/4 = 0.0510$. Margins $1.753(0.0510) = 0.0894$, $2.131(0.0510) = 0.1087$, $2.947(0.0510) = 0.1503$. CIs are 0.2406 plus or minus each.

Answer.

Level	$n = 50$ (z)	$n = 16$ (t_{15})
90%	(0.1638, 0.2698)	(0.1512, 0.3300)
95%	(0.1537, 0.2800)	(0.1319, 0.3493)
99%	(0.1339, 0.2998)	(0.0903, 0.3909)

All six contain $\mu = 0.2083$.

Usual mistake. Trusting the t interval at $n = 16$ on skewed data. The CI p.67 example, $n = 16$ from a skewed population, covers only about 91% at nominal 95% and runs too narrow.

HW4 2a. Batching. 16 values in draw order into 4 batches of 4, CI from the batch means with t on 3 df

Question. *Then, for the smaller sample only (size 16), compute the 90%, 95% and 99% intervals two further ways. These correspond to the first and third responses on the lecture slides for when the normality assumption fails. 2a. Batching. Group your 16 observations into 4 batches of 4 and compute the mean of each batch. You now have 4 numbers. Compute the confidence intervals from those 4 batch means, using the t distribution with 3 degrees of freedom. Batch the observations in the order you drew them. Do not sort the sample first, sorting would group the small values together and the large values together, and the batch means would no longer be four draws from the same distribution.*

In plain words. Batching is a trick to make data look more normal. Averaging groups of 4 values gives batch means that are closer to normal than the raw values, the CLT done by hand. You then treat the 4 batch means as your whole sample, which leaves only $4 - 1 = 3$ degrees of freedom.

1. Average groups of 4 or more to push toward normal (CI p.68). Keep draw order, since sorting would make each batch a different slice.
2. Batch means 0.4212, 0.2368, 0.0904, 0.2139. *Formula.* $\bar{x} = \frac{1}{b}\sum \bar{x}_j$, where $\bar{x}_j$ is batch j's mean and $b = 4$ batches. *Plug in.* 0.9623/4. *Result.* 0.2406, same as the raw mean.
3. Variance of the batch means. *Formula.* $s^2 = \dfrac{\sum \bar{x}_j^2 - (\sum \bar{x}_j)^2/b}{b-1}$. *Plug in.* $\sum \bar{x}_j^2 = 0.2874$ and $(\sum \bar{x}_j)^2/4 = 0.9623^2/4 = 0.2315$. *Work it out.* $(0.2874 - 0.2315)/3 = 0.0559/3 = 0.0186$, $s = \sqrt{0.0186} = 0.1365$. *Result.* $\text{SE} = s/\sqrt{b} = 0.1365/2 = 0.0683$.
4. Margins with t on 3 df. $2.353(0.0683) = 0.161$, $3.182(0.0683) = 0.217$, $5.841(0.0683) = 0.399$. CIs are 0.2406 plus or minus each.

Answer. 90% (0.0799, 0.4012), 95% (0.0233, 0.4578), 99% (−0.1581, 0.6393). All contain μ.

By hand. 12 values into 3 batches with means 2, 4, 6. Mean $12/3 = 4$. $s^2 = ((2-4)^2 + (4-4)^2 + (6-4)^2)/2 = 8/2 = 4$, $s = 2$. $\text{SE} = 2/\sqrt{3} = 2/1.732 = 1.155$. df = 2, $t[0.025, 2] = 4.303$, margin $4.303 \times 1.155 = 4.97$. 95% CI $= 4 \pm 4.97 = (-0.97, 8.97)$. Batching needs lots of data.

HW4 2b. Bootstrap with $B = 10000$, seed 12345

Question. *2b. Bootstrap. Resample your 16 observations with replacement, recompute the mean, and repeat many times. The percentiles of those resampled means give the interval.* [The given NumPy script draws the 16 from not-normal.txt without replacement using seed 12345, makes $B = 10000$ resamples of size 16 with replacement, and prints the $a = (1 - \text{level})/2$ and $1 - a$ quantiles of the resampled means for levels 0.90, 0.95, 0.99.] *If you are working in Excel or R instead, you may use any equivalent implementation, but report B, your seed, and the tool you used.*

In plain words. The bootstrap pretends your 16 values are the whole population. You draw new samples of 16 from them with replacement, many times, and watch how much the mean jumps around. The middle 95% of those means is your 95% interval, with no normal assumption needed.

1. Treat the sample as the population. Draw 16 with replacement, take the mean, repeat B times, where $B = 10000$ is the number of resamples (CI p.69).
2. Sort the means. 95% runs from the 2.5th to the 97.5th percentile, which is about the 250th and the 9750th of 10000 sorted means. 90% runs from the 5th to the 95th percentile, 99% from the 0.5th to the 99.5th.

Answer. 90% (0.1618, 0.3242), 95% (0.1493, 0.3407), 99% (0.1230, 0.3705). All contain 0.2083.

By hand. Sample $\{2, 4, 9\}$. Resamples $\{2, 2, 9\}$ mean $13/3 = 4.33$, $\{4, 9, 9\}$ mean $22/3 = 7.33$, $\{2, 4, 4\}$ mean $10/3 = 3.33$, $\{9, 2, 4\}$ mean $15/3 = 5$. Repeat thousands of times, sort, read the percentiles.

Usual mistake. Resampling without replacement gives the same mean every time. If the 16 values missed the tail, every resample misses it too (CI p.69 to 70).

HW4 2c. Compare raw, batched and bootstrap at $n = 16$

Question. *2c. Compare.*

1. *Put the three sets of intervals for the sample of 16, raw, batched, and bootstrapped, into a single table, at all three confidence levels. State for each whether it contains the population mean.*
2. *Which method gives the widest intervals, and which the narrowest? Was that what you expected before computing them?*
3. *The batched interval is meant to correct for the data not being normal. Explain why the correction makes the interval wider rather than narrower, and say what you gave up to obtain it.*
4. *Look at your 99% batched interval. Does it contain any values that are impossible for this quantity? What does that tell you about the method at this sample size?*
5. *Your sample either did or did not contain the population mean. Explain why that single outcome does not, on its own, tell you whether a method's coverage is correct.*

In plain words. This lines up the three methods side by side and asks you to explain the pattern. Batching is widest because 3 df make the t value big. Bootstrap is narrowest because it can only see the spread inside the 16 values you already have.

Width = upper end minus lower end. For example raw 95% is $0.3493 - 0.1319 = 0.217$.

	Raw t	Batched	Bootstrap
90% width	0.179	0.321	0.162
95% width	0.217	0.435	0.191
99% width	0.301	0.797	0.248

Steps 1 to 5 answer parts 1 to 5 of 2c.

1. All nine contain 0.2083.
2. Batching is widest and bootstrap narrowest at every level. That's what we expected, since the slides predict it (CI p.68 says about 50% wider, CI p.70 calls bootstrap the narrowest). Here batching was about twice as wide ($0.435/0.217 = 2.0$) because the batch means were spread out.
3. Batching widens because df fall from 15 to 3, so t goes from 2.131 to 3.182, and here the SE also rose from 0.0510 to 0.0683. The cost is precision and any statement about individual values.
4. The 99% batched interval reaches −0.158, impossible for positive data. Too few df at high confidence.

5. Coverage is a long-run rate over repeated samples (CI p.33). One hit is consistent with 95% and with 91%, so you'd have to repeat the draw and count.

Which fix when. Correlated observations, batch. Median or a multiplicative process, transform. Mean with independent data, bootstrap (CI p.70).

The third fix by hand, transform. HW4 skipped it, but it's the other response on CI p.68. Data 1, 10, 100.

1. Take $\log_{10}$ to get 0, 1, 2. Mean $3/3 = 1$. $s^2 = ((0-1)^2 + 0 + (2-1)^2)/2 = 2/2 = 1$, $s = 1$.
2. SE $= 1/\sqrt{3} = 0.577$. With $t[0.025, 2] = 4.303$ the margin is $4.303 \times 0.577 = 2.48$.
3. Log-scale CI $1 \pm 2.48 = (-1.48, 3.48)$.
4. Back-transform with 10^x. $10^{-1.48} = 0.033$ and $10^{3.48} \approx 3050$, centred on $10^1 = 10$.

That's an interval for the median (here the geometric mean), not the mean, which is $111/3 = 37$ (CI p.68 trap).

HW4 Problem 3. Confidence intervals in the wild, 8 questions

Question. *Problem 3, A paper from the wild. Work through the homework exercise in Part III of the companion handout Confidence Intervals in the Wild. Read only the experimental setup and results sections of the paper you choose, and answer all eight questions there. Two or three sentences per question is enough. Give the full citation at the top. Choosing the paper is part of the exercise. Pick the entry from Part I of the handout that sits closest to your own research area, or any peer-reviewed paper from that area, ideally one you would cite anyway, that reports experimental results with confidence intervals, error bars, or any other statement of uncertainty. Papers that report results with no statement of uncertainty are also fair game, and often more revealing.* [Defaults if no area fits are entry 4, Georges et al., Statistically Rigorous Java Performance Evaluation, OOPSLA 2007, or entry 13, Henning et al., When Should I Run My Application Benchmark?, FSE Companion 2025. The eight handout questions are printed in italics at the start of each answer under "His paper" below.]

In plain words. You pick a real paper and audit how it reports uncertainty, using 8 fixed questions. The point is to spot when an error bar promises more than it should, usually because the observations weren't independent or the interval ignores systematic error. Two or three sentences per question is enough.

Checklist.

1. Paper and why.
2. Locate the first interval or error bar. Finding none is a finding.
3. Estimator. Mean, proportion, ratio, quantile, GM? Which lecture formula fits?
4. n. Justified, or just asserted?
5. Assumption. What does the interval assume? If skewed with small n, which of batch, transform, bootstrap (CI p.68)?
6. Independence. What's the unit, and are the units really independent (CI p.66)?
7. What the interval excludes. Systematic error, setup, population (CI p.17).
8. Interpretation. Do they claim "95% probability the true value is inside", which needs a credible interval?

His paper. Yan et al., Puffer, NSDI 2020.

1. *Say what you picked and why. Give the full citation and one or two sentences on how the paper relates to your own work.* Video streaming, already cited in HW2, and no Part I entry fits.
2. *Locate the interval. Quote the sentence or identify the figure where an interval or error bar first appears. If you cannot find one, say so, that is a finding, and the rest of the questions still apply to whatever the paper reports in its place.* Sec. 3.4, "95% CI on stall ratio between ±13% and ±21% of the mean". Fig. 9 error bars are 95% CIs.
3. *Identify the estimator. Mean, proportion, variance, quantile, geometric mean, or something else? Which formula from lecture applies, if any?* Stall ratio is a ratio, so bootstrap. Average SSIM is a duration-weighted mean with a z interval.
4. *Find n. How many measurements? Is the choice justified, or asserted?* 637,189 streams from 54,612 IPs, about 2.5 to 2.8 stream-years per scheme. That's whatever 8 months gave, not planned. The "2 stream-years to separate a 15% difference" is unexplained.
5. *Check the assumption. What distributional assumption does their interval require, and do the authors address it? If the response is plainly not normal and n is small, which of the three responses on slide 68 did they use, and if none, which would you have used?* Stalls are very skewed (4% of streams stalled). Bootstrap fits, but B and the interval type aren't stated.
6. *Check the independence. What is the unit being treated as an independent draw, a run, a request, a benchmark, a user, a seed? Are consecutive units plausibly independent, or is this an entry-15 situation dressed up as an entry-1 situation?* Randomized by session but the bootstrap resamples streams, which share a connection. The intervals are likely too narrow. Resample sessions.
7. *Check what the interval excludes. Name one source of error in their setup that the interval does not cover (pitfall 3).* One Stanford server, self-selected viewers, no Safari. Says nothing about other users or servers.
8. *Check the interpretation. Do the authors state a conclusion that requires a credible interval while computing a confidence interval?* No credible-interval claim. But they compare schemes by error-bar overlap, which isn't a test.

Exam scenario. "Mean RPC latency was 4.2 ms ± 0.1 ms (95% CI) from 10,000 requests in one run on one machine, so there is a 95% chance the true mean is between 4.1 and 4.3." Walk the checklist.

1. The claim is a single mean latency with a 95% CI, plus a probability reading of that CI. There's no paper to pick, so say what's being claimed.
2. The interval is 4.2 ± 0.1 ms, labelled 95%. Working backwards, $0.1 = 1.96\, s/\sqrt{10000}$ gives $s = 0.1 \times 100/1.96 = 5.1$ ms, so the per-request SD is about 5 ms, bigger than the mean. That fits skewed latency.
3. Estimator is a mean, z formula since n is large (CI p.31).
4. $n = 10{,}000$ is asserted, and it counts requests, not runs.
5. Latency is skewed, but for a mean at this n the CLT is fine (CI p.29).
6. The real problem. Consecutive requests share caches, queues and load, so they aren't independent and the interval is too narrow (CI p.66). Batch the requests or do several runs with one mean per run (CI p.70, HT p.22).
7. One machine, one run. Systematic error and the setup aren't in the interval (CI p.17).
8. "95% chance the true mean is inside" is a credible-interval claim. A CI only says the procedure covers μ in 95% of repeats (CI p.33). Honest headline. "In one run on one machine, mean RPC latency was 4.2 ms. The ±0.1 ms treats 10,000 back-to-back requests as independent, so the real uncertainty is larger, and we'd need several independent runs to give an honest inter-

val. Nothing here covers other machines."

HW5. Hypothesis testing

HW5 1.1. $\sigma = 0.8$ h known, $n = 36$, $\bar{x} = 2.74$. Test $H_0 : \mu = 2.5$ at $\alpha = 0.05$

Question. *Problem 1, Testing a mean with σ known. For a certain class of a new neural network architecture, we would like to test the hypothesis that the mean training time μ is equal to $\mu_0 = 2.5$ hours. The standard deviation is known to be 0.8 hours. 1. (7 points) Suppose we run experiments with 36 such systems and observe that the mean training time in our experiments is 2.74 hours. Test the null hypothesis $H_0 : \mu = 2.5$ hours at the level of significance $\alpha = 0.05$. Do you reject H_0 or fail to reject it?*

In plain words. A hypothesis test asks whether the data would be surprising if the boring claim H_0 (the mean is 2.5 h) were true. You measure how far the sample mean is from 2.5 in units of standard error, and that's Z. If $|Z|$ goes past 1.96, that would happen less than 5% of the time under H_0, so you reject it.

1. $H_0 : \mu = 2.5$, $H_1 : \mu \neq 2.5$. No direction is named, so two-sided (HT p.5).
2. *Formula.* σ is known, so $Z = \dfrac{\bar{x} - \mu_0}{\sigma/\sqrt{n}}$ (HT p.8), where $\bar{x} = 2.74$ is the sample mean, $\mu_0 = 2.5$ the value in H_0, $\sigma = 0.8$ the known SD and $n = 36$ the number of systems.
3. *Plug in.* $Z = \dfrac{2.74 - 2.5}{0.8/\sqrt{36}}$.
4. *Work it out.* SE $= 0.8/6 = 0.1333$. Top $= 0.24$. $Z = 0.24/0.1333$.
5. *Result.* $Z = 1.80$.
6. Decision rule. Two-sided at 0.05, reject if $|Z| > z[0.025] = 1.960$. Since $1.80 < 1.96$, fail to reject.
7. Interval check (HT p.9). $2.74 \pm 1.96(0.1333) = 2.74 \pm 0.261 = (2.479, 3.001)$ contains 2.5, same verdict.

Answer. $Z = 1.80$, fail to reject H_0. Matches main.tex.

Small version. $n = 16$, $\sigma = 0.8$, $\bar{x} = 2.9$. SE $= 0.8/\sqrt{16} = 0.8/4 = 0.2$. $Z = (2.9 - 2.5)/0.2 = 0.4/0.2 = 2.0 > 1.96$, reject. The HT p.10 example gives $Z = -2.83$ and rejects.

Usual mistake. Writing "accept H_0". Failing to reject isn't evidence for H_0 (HT p.4).

HW5 1.2. p-value and conclusion

Question. *2. (5 points) For the same experiments, find the p-value. Using the p-value you computed, restate the conclusion you reached in part 1.*

In plain words. The p-value is the chance of getting a result at least this far from 2.5 if H_0 were true. A small p means the data would be surprising under H_0. You reject when $p < \alpha$, and that always gives the same verdict as the critical-value rule.

1. *Formula.* $p = P[\text{statistic this extreme} \mid H_0]$ (HT p.13). Two-sided, $p = 2\,(1 - \Phi(|Z|))$.
2. *Plug in.* $p = 2\,(1 - \Phi(1.80))$.
3. *Work it out.* $1 - 0.9641 = 0.0359$, then 2×0.0359.
4. *Result.* $p = 0.0718$.

Answer. $p = 0.072 > 0.05$, so fail to reject H_0. Same conclusion as part 1, the data don't show the mean differs from 2.5 h.

Usual mistake. Forgetting to double for two-sided, or saying "7% chance H_0 is true" (HT p.14).

HW5 1.3. $\alpha = 0.01$, $n = 36$. Smallest $\bar{x} > 2.5$ that rejects

Question. *3. (8 points) Suppose we reduce the level of significance to $\alpha = 0.01$. If we run experiments on 36 systems to test the null hypothesis that $\mu = 2.5$ hours, what is the minimum mean time (larger than 2.5 hours) we would need to observe to reject the hypothesis?*

In plain words. Flip the test around. Instead of asking whether a given mean rejects, find the cutoff mean where Z just hits the critical value. A smaller α means you demand stronger evidence, so the cutoff moves further from 2.5.

1. Two-sided at 0.01, so the critical value is $z[0.005] = 2.576$.
2. *Formula.* Reject when $\dfrac{\bar{x} - \mu_0}{\sigma/\sqrt{n}} > z[\alpha/2]$, so $\bar{x} > \mu_0 + z[\alpha/2]\,\sigma/\sqrt{n}$.
3. *Plug in.* $\bar{x} > 2.5 + 2.576 \times 0.8/6$.
4. *Work it out.* $0.8/6 = 0.1333$, $2.576 \times 0.1333 = 0.343$, $2.5 + 0.343$.
5. *Result.* $\bar{x} > 2.843$.
6. A one-sided $H_1 : \mu > 2.5$ would use $z[0.01] = 2.326$, so $2.5 + 2.326 \times 0.1333 = 2.5 + 0.310 = 2.810$.

Answer. About 2.84 h two-sided (2.81 one-sided). Matches main.tex.

Power version (HT p.19). How many runs to detect a shift of $\delta = 0.2$ h with 80% power at 0.05? *Formula.* $n = \left(\dfrac{(z[\alpha/2] + z[\beta])\,\sigma}{\delta}\right)^2$, where δ is the smallest shift you care about, power is $1 - \beta = 0.80$, and $z[0.20] = 0.84$. *Plug in.* $\left(\dfrac{(1.96 + 0.84) \times 0.8}{0.2}\right)^2$. *Work it out.* $2.80 \times 0.8 = 2.24$, $2.24/0.2 = 11.2$, $11.2^2 = 125.4$. *Result.* Round up to 126.

HW5 2.1. Suspect the mean time to first fault is below 740 h. H_0 and H_1?

Question. *Problem 2, Choosing the null hypothesis. A research group develops an autonomous driving system. Because of the specific sensor model adopted, they suspect that the mean time μ to experience the first fault in the sensor subsystem is less than $\mu_0 = 740$ hours. 1. If we use hypothesis testing to confirm this assertion, what should be the null hypothesis H_0? What should be the alternative hypothesis H_1? Carefully justify your choices for H_0 and H_1.*

In plain words. A test can only ever reject H_0, never prove it. So whatever you want to show goes in H_1, here that the mean is below 740. The test is one-sided because only one direction matters.

1. The claim to establish goes in H_1, because a test only supports a claim by rejecting H_0 (HT p.4).
2. $H_0 : \mu = 740$ (or ≥ 740), $H_1 : \mu < 740$, one-sided (HT p.5).

Answer. $H_0 : \mu = 740$ h, $H_1 : \mu < 740$ h, one-sided, because rejecting H_0 is the only way the data can confirm the suspicion.

Usual mistake. Putting the claim in H_0, so a small noisy experiment "supports" it by failing to reject. Picking the side after seeing the data is a disguised two-sided test at double α (HT p.5).

HW5 2.2. $n = 50$, $\bar{x} = 706$, $s = 96.1$, $\alpha = 0.01$. Can we confirm $\mu < 740$?

Question. *2. Suppose we test 50 such systems and obtain a mean time to first fault of 706 hours, with a standard deviation of 96.1 hours. If the target level of significance is $\alpha = 0.01$, can we confirm, based on these experiments, the assertion that the mean time to first fault is less than 740 hours?*

In plain words. Now actually run the test from 2.1. σ isn't known, but with 50 systems the sample SD s is a good stand-in, so the Z formula works. One-sided at 0.01 means you reject only if Z is below -2.326.

1. σ is unknown but $n = 50$, so s stands in and $t \approx Z$ (HT p.11).
2. *Formula.* $Z = \dfrac{\bar{x} - \mu_0}{s/\sqrt{n}}$, where $\bar{x} = 706$, $\mu_0 = 740$, $s = 96.1$ the sample SD, $n = 50$.
3. *Plug in.* $Z = \dfrac{706 - 740}{96.1/\sqrt{50}}$.
4. *Work it out.* SE $= 96.1/7.071 = 13.59$. Top $= -34$. $Z = -34/13.59$.
5. *Result.* $Z = -2.50$.
6. Decision. One-sided, reject if $Z < -z[0.01] = -2.326$. Since $-2.50 < -2.326$, reject.
7. p-value. *Formula.* one-sided lower tail $p = \Phi(Z)$. *Plug in.* $\Phi(-2.50) = 1 - \Phi(2.50)$. *Work it out.* $1 - 0.9938$. *Result.* $p = 0.0062 < 0.01$.

Answer. Reject H_0, so the data confirm $\mu < 740$ at 0.01. With t_{49} (crit 2.405) the verdict is the same.

Small version. $n = 36$, $\bar{x} = 716$, $s = 60$. SE $= 60/6 = 10$. $Z = (716 - 740)/10 = -24/10 = -2.4 < -2.326$, reject. $p = 1 - \Phi(2.4) = 1 - 0.9918 = 0.0082$.

Exam variant, small n and the side matters. $n = 9$, $\bar{x} = 12$, $s = 3$, $\mu_0 = 10$, population roughly normal. SE $= 3/\sqrt{9} = 3/3 = 1$. $t = (12 - 10)/1 = 2.0$ with $9 - 1 = 8$ df. Two-sided at 0.05 needs $t[0.025, 8] = 2.306$, so fail to reject. One-sided $H_1 \colon \mu > 10$ (stated before the data) needs $t[0.05, 8] = 1.860$, so reject. That's why the side has to be fixed in advance (HT p.5, HT p.11).

HW5 Problem 3. Hypothesis testing in the wild, questions 0 to 6

Question. *Problem 3, A paper from the wild (60 points). Work through the homework exercise in Part III of the companion handout Hypothesis Testing in the Wild. Read only the experimental setup and results sections of the paper you choose, and answer all seven questions there. Two or three sentences per question is enough, except for the last question, which asks you to rewrite the paper's key result as an effect size with a confidence interval. Give the full citation at the top. Choosing the paper is part of the exercise. Pick the entry from Part I of the handout that sits closest to your own research area, or any peer-reviewed paper from that area, ideally one you would cite anyway, that makes a claim of the form "A is better than B". Papers that make that claim with no test and no statement of uncertainty are also fair game, and often more revealing. Several entries (1, 3, 4, 7, 9 and 10) are about statistical practice rather than about one system beating another. If you pick one of them, apply the questions to the paper's own central empirical claim.* [Defaults if no area fits are Mytkowicz et al., Producing Wrong Data Without Doing Anything Obviously Wrong!, ASPLOS 2009, or Musgrave et al., A Metric Learning Reality Check, ECCV 2020. The seven handout questions, 0 to 6, are printed in italics at the start of each answer under "His paper" below.]

In plain words. Pick a paper that claims A beats B and audit its testing with 7 fixed questions. Mostly you're checking the things papers skip, like what counts as one independent observation, how many tests they ran, and whether they peeked. The last question rewrites the main result as an effect size, the actual size of the difference, with a CI.

Checklist.

0. Paper and why.
1. H_0, H_1, one or two-sided. Reconstruct if missing and say so.
2. Test and assumptions (normality, independence, pairing, equal variances). The unit, and does n count units or measurements (HT p.20)?
3. α, n, power. With no power analysis, the detectable effect is about 2.8×SE at $\alpha = 0.05$ and 80% power (HT p.19).
4. Count the tests. FWER $= 1 - (1 - \alpha)^m$ (HT p.27). Any correction, and FWER or FDR (HT p.28)?
5. Stopping rule (peeking, HT p.23 to 24), interference (HT p.22), right estimand.
6. Rewrite as an effect size with a CI (HT p.16, p.18). Big enough to matter?

His paper. Spang et al., Unbiased Experiments in Congested Networks, IMC 2021 (entry 8).

0. *Say what you picked and why. Give the full citation and one or two sentences on how the paper relates to your own work.* Closest to video streaming, and his comparisons share a bottleneck too.
1. *Write down H_0 and H_1. For the paper's central claim, state the null and alternative hypotheses, and whether the test is one- or two-sided. If the paper never states them, reconstruct them, and say so.* Not stated. Reconstructed $H_0 \colon \text{TTE} = 0$ against $H_1 \colon \text{TTE} \neq 0$, two-sided since the CIs are two-sided.
2. *Identify the test and its assumptions. Which test was used, if any? What does it assume (normality, independence, pairing, equal variances)? Do the authors check or address those assumptions? What is the experimental unit, and does n count units or measurements (slide 20)?* No named test. Regression on hourly means with Newey-West SEs. The unit is the session but n counts hour cells, since sessions in one hour share congestion. An A/A test and a baseline week check that the links match.
3. *Find α, n, and β. What significance level? How many observations, and what is an observation (a run, a seed, a benchmark, a user)? Is there any power analysis? If not, estimate roughly what effect size the experiment could have detected.* $\alpha = 0.05$ implied. About 14M sessions but only a few dozen hour cells. No power analysis. SE about 2.6, so the detectable effect is about $2.8 \times 2.6 \approx 7\%$.
4. *Count the tests. How many comparisons does the paper make in total? What is the family-wise error rate if none were corrected (slide 27)? Is there a correction, and does the choice between family-wise error and false discovery rate control fit the paper's claims (slide 28)?* 28 intervals in Fig. 5 (7 metrics × 4), plus 24 baseline metrics. FWER $= 1 - 0.95^{28} = 1 - 0.24 = 0.76$. No correction, and FDR fits the claim better.
5. *Check the stopping rule and the estimand. Was n fixed in advance, or could the authors have kept running until the result was significant (slides 23 to 25)? Could units in the experiment have interfered with each other (slide 22)? Does the test measure the quantity the paper's claim is about (pitfall 7)?* 5 days, not said to be fixed in advance. Interference is the paper's point. The naive A/B test measures the effect at 5% allocation, not the effect of deploying to everyone.
6. *Rewrite the result. Rewrite the paper's key sentence as an effect size with a confidence interval, as slides 16 and 18 recommend. Is the effect large enough to matter? Does the claim become stronger, weaker, or different?* Capping raised throughput

12% (95% CI about 7% to 17%), while the naive test said −5% (about −8% to −2%). The claim gets stronger since the sign flips, and the exact size is less certain.

By hand, FWER. *Formula.* FWER $= 1-(1-\alpha)^m$, the chance of at least one false positive when you run m tests at level α and every H_0 is true (HT p.27). *Plug in.* $m=10$, $\alpha=0.05$, so $1-0.95^{10}$. *Work it out.* $0.95^{10}=0.599$, $1-0.599$. *Result.* 0.40. Bonferroni (HT p.28) tests each at $\alpha/m=0.05/10=0.005$.

Where 2.8 comes from. $z[0.025]+z[0.20]=1.96+0.84=2.80$, the same sum as in the HW5 1.3 power version.

Exam scenario. "A new congestion controller ran on 10% of flows sharing links with the old one. We checked p daily and stopped on day 6 at $p=0.04$. Of 8 metrics, throughput was significantly better."

0. The claim is that the new controller gives better throughput, from a live test at 10% allocation. There's no paper to pick, so say what's being claimed.
1. No H_0 stated. Reconstruct H_0 no throughput difference, H_1 better, and ask if the side was fixed in advance (HT p.5).
2. Unit is the flow, but flows on one link aren't independent (HT p.20).
3. No power analysis, n wasn't fixed (HT p.19).
4. 8 metrics give FWER $=1-0.95^8=1-0.66=0.34$ with no correction (HT p.27 to 28). Bonferroni would need $p<0.05/8=0.00625$, and 0.04 fails that.
5. Daily peeking inflates the Type I error well past 5% (HT p.23 to 24). At 10% allocation the new flows interfere with the old, so this isn't the effect of deploying to everyone (HT p.22).
6. Report the throughput difference with a CI, not "significantly better" (HT p.16). Honest headline. "At 10% allocation, flows on the new controller had higher throughput by [difference] (95% CI [low, high]). This was 1 of 8 metrics, checked daily with no correction for peeking or multiple tests, so it's a lead to retest with a fixed sample size, not a finding."

HW6. Comparing two alternatives

HW6 P1. Same workload on routing A and B, 9 rows of delay. Is A better at 95%?

Question. *Problem 1, Two routing algorithms (20 points). Two packet routing algorithms are being evaluated. Experiments were conducted by injecting the same workload in the network and measuring the average end-to-end packet delay. The results of the various experiments are shown in Table 1. Can you say with 95% confidence that routing algorithm A is better than algorithm B?* [Table 1 is the A and B columns below, 9 experiments, rows 1 to 5 on the left half and 6 to 9 on the right.]

In plain words. The same workload ran on both, so each row is a matched pair. Take the difference in each row and build an ordinary one-sample CI on those 9 differences. If the CI includes 0, you can't say either one is better.

A	B	d	d^2	A	B	d	d^2
115.0	125.3	−10.3	106.09	120.3	87.9	32.4	1049.76
89.3	97.6	−8.3	68.89	98.9	104.2	−5.3	28.09
102.1	85.3	16.8	282.24	87.6	96.3	−8.7	75.69
94.3	101.3	−7.0	49.00	104.5	113.2	−8.7	75.69
117.3	112.7	4.6	21.16				

1. The same workload ran under both, so paired. Work on $d_i=A_i-B_i$, the delay of A minus the delay of B in row i. Negative favours A, since lower delay is better (Comp p.5, p.9).
2. Mean difference. *Formula.* $\bar{d}=\frac{1}{n}\sum d_i$, where $n=9$ pairs. *Plug in.* Positives $16.8+4.6+32.4=53.8$, negatives $-10.3-8.3-7.0-5.3-8.7-8.7=-48.3$. *Work it out.* $\sum d=53.8-48.3=5.5$, $\bar{d}=5.5/9$. *Result.* 0.611.
3. SD of the differences. *Formula.* $s_d^2=\dfrac{\sum d_i^2-(\sum d_i)^2/n}{n-1}$. *Plug in.* $\sum d^2=1756.61$ from the table, so $\dfrac{1756.61-5.5^2/9}{8}$. *Work it out.* $5.5^2/9=30.25/9=3.36$, $1756.61-3.36=1753.25$, $1753.25/8=219.16$. *Result.* $s_d=\sqrt{219.16}=14.80$.
4. SE. *Formula.* SE $=s_d/\sqrt{n}$. *Plug in.* $14.80/\sqrt{9}$. *Work it out.* $14.80/3$. *Result.* 4.935.
5. CI. *Formula.* $\bar{d}\pm t[\alpha/2,n-1]\times$SE, with df $=9-1=8$ pairs minus one. *Plug in.* $0.611\pm2.306\times4.935$. *Work it out.* $2.306\times4.935=11.38$. $0.611-11.38=-10.77$ and $0.611+11.38=11.99$. *Result.* CI $=(-10.77, 11.99)$, which contains 0.

Answer. No, you can't say A is better at 95%. Matches main.tex. It isn't evidence they're equal either, since the CI allows A 10.8 better or 12.0 worse.

Check. "Is A better than B?" is a one-sided question by HT p.5, and he used a two-sided interval. The verdict doesn't change. A is better only if $\bar{d}<0$, and $\bar{d}=+0.611$ points the other way, so the one-sided test with $t[0.05,8]=1.860$ can't reject either.

By hand. Four differences 2, 4, 3, 3. $\bar{d}=12/4=3$. Deviations $-1,1,0,0$, so $s_d^2=2/3=0.667$, $s_d=0.816$. SE $=0.816/\sqrt{4}=0.408$. df $=3$, margin $3.182\times0.408=1.30$. CI $3\pm1.30=(1.70,4.30)$ excludes 0.

Sign test on the HW6 data (Comp p.23). *Formula.* Under H_0 each difference is equally likely to be positive or negative, so the count of positives S follows a binomial with $n=9$ and chance 1/2. $P[S\le s]=\sum_{k=0}^{s}\binom{9}{k}/2^9$. *Plug in.* 3 positive out of 9, so $P[S\le3]=\dfrac{\binom{9}{0}+\binom{9}{1}+\binom{9}{2}+\binom{9}{3}}{512}$. *Work it out.* $\dfrac{1+9+36+84}{512}=\dfrac{130}{512}=0.254$. Two-sided doubles it. *Result.* $p=0.51$.

Usual mistake. Analysing paired data as unpaired. Comp p.8 shows the same data giving $(0.65, 3.00)$ paired and $(-22.0, 25.7)$ unpaired. The df come from pairs, $n-1=8$ (Comp p.9).

HW6 P2. CPU times, 30 on A and 24 on B. Is A faster at 90%?

Question. *Problem 2, Two computer systems (20 points). Two computer systems are being evaluated for their performance. Data corresponding to the CPU time for running some transactions on System A and System B are reported in Table 2. Is System A faster than System B at the 90% confidence level?* [Table 2, CPU time in seconds. System A (30 values) 1.3779, 0.0457, 1.4415, 1.3589, 0.6898, 0.7076, 3.9083, 2.2081, 0.9244, 6.5770, 4.4775, 4.6199, 0.1775, 0.3354, 0.3687, 0.0956, 1.2116, 3.8814, 0.2922, 3.0970, 3.2150, 1.2880, 3.0046, 6.8230, 0.7478, 0.3845, 0.2354, 0.9951, 0.3045, 1.6950. System B (24 values) 0.9584, 0.5726, 1.3915, 0.8075, 0.1344, 0.1277, 1.8032, 1.2048, 9.5949, 4.9107, 0.2834, 0.3841, 0.0812, 2.1362, 4.6396, 1.0127, 2.9434, 1.0844, 0.7860, 2.1536, 1.4948, 11.7346, 0.9436, 3.1111.]

In plain words. Different transactions ran on each system, in different counts, so there's nothing to pair. You compare the two means with the Welch method, which doesn't assume both systems have the same variance. It builds a CI on the difference in means and has its own formula for the degrees of freedom, called ν.

1. Different transactions and unequal sizes, so unpaired. Welch by default (Comp p.12 to 13).
2. From the data, A has $n_A=30$, $\bar{x}_A=1.8830$, $s_A=1.9017$. B has $n_B=24$, $\bar{x}_B=2.2623$, $s_B=2.9108$. Difference $\bar{x}_A-\bar{x}_B=1.8830-2.2623=-0.3793$.

3. SE of the difference. *Formula.* $s = \sqrt{s_A^2/n_A + s_B^2/n_B}$, where s_A^2 is A's sample variance and n_A its count, same for B. *Plug in.* $\sqrt{1.9017^2/30 + 2.9108^2/24}$. *Work it out.* $1.9017^2 = 3.6166$, $/30 = 0.12055$. $2.9108^2 = 8.4727$, $/24 = 0.35303$. Sum 0.47358. *Result.* $s = \sqrt{0.47358} = 0.6882$.
4. Welch df. *Formula.* $\nu = \dfrac{(s_A^2/n_A + s_B^2/n_B)^2}{\dfrac{(s_A^2/n_A)^2}{n_A - 1} + \dfrac{(s_B^2/n_B)^2}{n_B - 1}}$. *Plug in.* $\nu = \dfrac{0.47358^2}{0.12055^2/29 + 0.35303^2/23}$. *Work it out.* Top $0.47358^2 = 0.22428$. Bottom $0.014532/29 = 0.000501$ plus $0.124630/23 = 0.005419$, total 0.005920. $0.22428/0.005920$. *Result.* $\nu = 37.89$.
5. CI. *Formula.* $(\bar{x}_A - \bar{x}_B) \pm t[\alpha/2, \nu] \times s$, with 90% so $\alpha/2 = 0.05$. *Plug in.* $-0.3793 \pm 1.686 \times 0.6882$. *Work it out.* $1.686 \times 0.6882 = 1.160$. $-0.3793 - 1.160 = -1.540$ and $-0.3793 + 1.160 = 0.781$. *Result.* CI = $(-1.540, 0.781)$.
6. Test statistic for reference. $t = (\bar{x}_A - \bar{x}_B)/s = -0.3793/0.6882 = -0.55$, $p = 0.58$.

Answer. 0 is inside, so A isn't shown to be faster at 90%. Matches main.tex. Rounding ν down to 37 by hand gives 1.687 and $(-1.540, 0.782)$.

Check. The same one-sided point applies. "Is A faster" is one-sided. At 90% one-sided, $t[0.10, 37.9] = 1.304$ and the upper bound is $-0.379 + 1.304(0.688) = -0.379 + 0.897 = 0.518 > 0$. Still not shown, so the verdict holds, but say the test is one-sided.

By hand. A = 2, 4, 6, 8 and B = 6, 8, 10, 12, 14.

1. Means $20/4 = 5$ and $50/5 = 10$. Variances $s_A^2 = (9 + 1 + 1 + 9)/3 = 6.67$ and $s_B^2 = (16 + 4 + 0 + 4 + 16)/4 = 10$.
2. Pieces $6.67/4 = 1.667$ and $10/5 = 2$. $s = \sqrt{1.667 + 2} = \sqrt{3.667} = 1.915$.
3. $\nu = \dfrac{3.667^2}{1.667^2/3 + 2^2/4} = \dfrac{13.44}{0.926 + 1} = \dfrac{13.44}{1.926} = 6.98$, round down to 6.
4. 90% CI. $t[0.05, 6] = 1.943$, margin $1.943 \times 1.915 = 3.72$. $(5 - 10) \pm 3.72 = (-8.72, -1.28)$, which excludes 0, so A is smaller.

Usual mistake. Using $n - 1$ of one sample as the df, or reading overlap of two separate CIs as "no difference" (Comp p.15 to 16).

Slide twin, paired (Comp p.11). Cache hit ratio on 6 workloads under policies A and B

In plain words. The same paired recipe as HW6 P1, on a tiny example from the slides. The lesson is to check which t value the slide used, since that decides whether it's a 90% or a 95% interval.

1. Differences $d_i = A_i - B_i$ are +0.07, +0.09, −0.05, −0.06, +0.10, −0.03. *Formula.* $\bar{d} = \frac{1}{n}\sum d_i$. *Plug in.* $\sum d = 0.26 - 0.14 = 0.12$, $n = 6$. *Result.* $\bar{d} = 0.12/6 = 0.020$.
2. $\sum d^2 = 0.0049 + 0.0081 + 0.0025 + 0.0036 + 0.0100 + 0.0009 = 0.0300$.
3. *Formula.* $s_d^2 = \dfrac{\sum d^2 - (\sum d)^2/n}{n - 1}$. *Plug in.* $\dfrac{0.0300 - 0.12^2/6}{5}$. *Work it out.* $0.0144/6 = 0.0024$, $(0.0300 - 0.0024)/5 = 0.0276/5 = 0.00552$. *Result.* $s_d = 0.0743$.
4. SE $= 0.0743/\sqrt{6} = 0.0743/2.449 = 0.0303$.
5. The slide multiplies by $t[0.05, 5] = 2.015$, so margin $2.015 \times 0.0303 = 0.061$ and its interval $0.020 \pm 0.061 = (-0.041, +0.081)$ is a 90% interval. For 95% use $t[0.025, 5] = 2.571$, giving $0.020 \pm 0.078 = (-0.058, 0.098)$.

Answer. Contains 0, so no difference shown, and the width is the finding (Comp p.11).

Slide twin, unpaired Welch (Comp p.14). A has $n = 7$, mean 0.2657, SD 0.0934. B has $n = 9$, mean 0.4011, SD 0.1447

In plain words. The same Welch recipe as HW6 P2, with small numbers from the slides. This time the CI misses 0, so this one does show a difference.

1. *Formula.* $s = \sqrt{s_A^2/n_A + s_B^2/n_B}$. *Plug in.* $\sqrt{0.0934^2/7 + 0.1447^2/9}$. *Work it out.* $0.001246 + 0.002326 = 0.003572$. *Result.* $s = 0.0598$.
2. *Formula.* Welch ν as in HW6 P2. *Plug in.* $\nu = \dfrac{0.003572^2}{0.001246^2/6 + 0.002326^2/8}$. *Work it out.* Top 1.276×10^{-5}. Bottom $2.59 \times 10^{-7} + 6.76 \times 10^{-7} = 9.35 \times 10^{-7}$. *Result.* $\nu = 13.6$.
3. Difference $0.2657 - 0.4011 = -0.135$. $t[0.05, 13.6] = 1.765$, margin $1.765 \times 0.0598 = 0.106$.
4. 90% CI $= -0.135 \pm 0.106 = (-0.241, -0.029)$.

Answer. The CI excludes 0, so B has the higher hit ratio, by 3 to 24 points.

HW6 Problem 3. Comparing two systems in the wild, 8 questions

Question. *Problem 3, A paper from the wild (60 points). Work through the homework exercise in Part III of the companion handout Comparing Two Systems in the Wild. Read only the experimental setup and results sections of the paper you choose, and answer all eight questions there. Two or three sentences per question is enough, except for the last question, which asks you to rewrite the paper's headline comparison as an effect with a confidence interval and to say what the experiment could not have detected. Give the full citation at the top. Choosing the paper is part of the exercise. Pick the entry from Part I of the handout that sits closest to your own research area, or any peer-reviewed paper from that area, ideally one you would cite anyway, that compares exactly two systems, models, algorithms or configurations. "Ours" versus a baseline is ideal. Papers that make that comparison with no test and no statement of uncertainty are also fair game, and often more revealing. Several entries (4, 5, 9, 10 and 11) are guides to, or surveys of, statistical practice rather than a comparison of two systems. If you pick one of them, apply the questions to the paper's own central empirical claim.* [Defaults if no area fits are Curtsinger and Berger, STABILIZER, ASPLOS 2013 (unpaired t), Dietterich, Approximate Statistical Tests for Comparing Supervised Classification Learning Algorithms, 1998 (paired t), or Klees et al., Evaluating Fuzz Testing, CCS 2018 (Mann-Whitney U). The eight handout questions are printed in italics at the start of each answer under "His paper" below.]

In plain words. Pick a paper comparing two systems and audit it with 8 fixed questions. The big ones are whether the data should've been paired, whether error-bar overlap was used as a test, and whether the difference is big enough to matter. The last question rewrites the headline as a difference with a CI, plus the smallest difference the experiment could have caught.

Checklist.

1. Paper and why.
2. Design. Paired or unpaired, the unit, units per system (Comp p.5).
3. If unpaired, could it be paired? How much variance is between units (Comp p.6)?
4. Which test, and are df and an exact p reported? If no test, what instead?
5. Is the response normal, or a bounded score, ratio, quantile? Would a rank test or bootstrap be better (Comp p.17 to 18)?

6. Are error bars defined in the caption? Any conclusion from overlap (Comp p.15 to 16)?
7. Effect size in real units with an interval. Big enough, and who decides (Comp p.24)?
8. Rewrite the headline with an interval plus what it couldn't detect (Comp p.25).

His paper. Miller, Adding Error Bars to Evals, arXiv 2411.00640, 2024 (entry 3).

1. *Say what you picked and why. Full citation and a sentence on its relation to your work.* He compares VLMs on the same benchmark questions.
2. *Identify the design. Paired or unpaired? What is the unit, a benchmark, a test-set example, a run, a user? How many units per system?* Paired, with the question as the unit (the cluster for MGSM). Example models on 5000 MATH, 164 HumanEval, 2500 MGSM.
3. *If it is unpaired, could it have been paired? If yes, estimate what that would have bought. How much of the observed variance is between units rather than between systems?* Already paired. In Miller's example a correlation of 0.5 cuts the variance from 1/6 to 1/9, so the SE shrinks by $\sqrt{(1/9)/(1/6)} = \sqrt{2/3} = 0.82$, about 18%.
4. *Find the comparison. Which test, if any? Is the statistic reported with its degrees of freedom and an exact p? If there is no test, what is offered instead?* Paired z on per-question differences, ±1.96 SE. No df, no p. Significant if the CI excludes 0.
5. *Check the assumptions. Is the response plausibly normal, or is it a bounded score, a ratio, or a quantile? Would a rank-based test or a bootstrap have been more defensible (slides 17 to 18)?* Scores are 0 or 1, not normal, so it leans on the CLT. Fine for 5000, but a paired bootstrap or sign test is safer for 164.
6. *Look at the figure. If there are error bars, does the caption say what they are? Is any conclusion drawn from their overlap (slides 15 to 16)?* No figures, only SEs in tables. Single-model CIs on MATH overlap though the paired CI excludes 0.
7. *Find the effect size. What is the difference, in the units of the response, and does the paper give an interval for it? Is the difference large enough to matter, and who decides?* MATH difference +2.5 points, 95% CI (1.2, 3.8). Whether that matters is left to the user.
8. *Rewrite the claim. Restate the paper's headline comparison as an effect with an interval, and add the sentence about what the experiment could not have detected.* Galleon beat Dreadnought by 2.5 points on MATH (1.2 to 3.8). HumanEval −3.1 (−7.2, 1.0) and MGSM −2.7 (−6.1, 0.7) are consistent with no difference. HumanEval's SE is 2.1, so it couldn't reliably detect under about $2.8 \times 2.1 \approx 6$ points.

Exam scenario. "Compiler X and Y were each run on the same 8 benchmarks. An unpaired t test gave $p = 0.4$, and the error bars overlap, so the compilers perform the same."

1. The claim is that two compilers perform the same, based on a non-significant unpaired test and overlapping error bars over 8 benchmarks. There's no paper to pick, so say what's being claimed.
2. Same benchmarks under both, so it's paired with the benchmark as the unit (Comp p.5).
3. Unpaired throws away the correlation. Between-benchmark spread swamps the difference, as in Comp p.8 where the same data give $p = 0.87$ unpaired and $p = 0.008$ paired.
4. They ran an unpaired t and gave only p. Use a paired t on the 8 differences with $8 - 1 = 7$ df and report t, df and the exact p (Comp p.26).
5. Run times are skewed, so analyse log times or use the signed-rank test (Comp p.18, Comp p.21).
6. The bars aren't defined, and overlap isn't a test (Comp p.15).
7. Give the mean difference with a CI. "Perform the same" doesn't follow from a non-significant result.
8. Honest headline. "On the same 8 benchmarks, X's run time minus Y's averaged $\bar{d}$, with paired 95% CI $\bar{d} \pm 2.365\, s_d/\sqrt{8}$, using $t[0.025, 7] = 2.365$. With only 8 benchmarks we couldn't reliably detect a difference smaller than about $3.3\, s_d/\sqrt{8}$." The 3.3 is $t[0.025, 7] + t[0.20, 7] = 2.365 + 0.896$, the small-sample version of the 2.8×SE rule (HT p.19).

One checklist for any experiment on the exam

1. Claim and hypotheses, with the direction chosen before the data (HT p.4 to 5).
2. Unit and n. Count runs, not requests from one run (HT p.20, CI p.66).
3. Paired or unpaired, and could it be paired (Comp p.5)?
4. Test fits the response, whether z, t, Welch, rank or bootstrap (Comp p.17 to 18, CI p.67).
5. Power or detectable effect (HT p.19).
6. Number of tests, and peeking (HT p.23 to 28).
7. Effect size with an interval in real units (HT p.16, Comp p.24).
8. What the interval misses, such as systematic error and interference (CI p.17, HT p.22).
9. Reading. No "equivalent" from non-significance, no verdicts from overlap, no "95% probability" for a CI (HT p.14, Comp p.15, CI p.33).

Practice. "Our scheduler cuts mean latency from 12.1 to 11.4 ms, $p < 0.05$, from one run of each with 10,000 requests, with the best of three workloads shown." The unit is the run, so $n = 1$ per system and the p means nothing. Three workloads are a hidden family of tests. There's no interval on the 0.7 ms. Fix it with several independent runs per system on all three workloads, paired by workload, reporting the difference and its CI.

Homework-style mock problems, no calculator

Mock 1 (HW3 style). Three runs of equal work report 40, 60 and 120 req/s. Mean rate?

In plain words. Three rates from equal amounts of work, so the honest mean rate is total work over total time, which is the harmonic mean. Using fractions with a common denominator keeps it calculator-free.

1. Rates with equal work, so harmonic (Summ p.28). *Formula.* $x_H = \dfrac{n}{\sum 1/x_i}$, with $n = 3$ runs.
2. *Plug in.* $x_H = \dfrac{3}{1/40 + 1/60 + 1/120}$.
3. *Work it out.* Over 120, $3/120 + 2/120 + 1/120 = 6/120 = 0.05$. Then $3/0.05$.
4. *Result.* $x_H = 60$ req/s. The AM would say $(40 + 60 + 120)/3 = 220/3 = 73.3$.

Answer. 60 req/s, harmonic mean.

Mock 2 (HW4 style). $n = 25$, $\bar{x} = 50$, $s = 10$, σ unknown. 90% CI?

In plain words. Small sample and unknown σ means a t interval with $n - 1 = 24$ degrees of freedom. It's the mean plus or minus t times the standard error $s/\sqrt{n}$.

1. $n < 30$ and σ unknown, so t with 24 df, assuming roughly normal data (CI p.37). *Formula.* $\bar{x} \pm t[0.05, 24]\, s/\sqrt{n}$.
2. *Plug in.* SE $= 10/\sqrt{25} = 10/5 = 2$. $t[0.05, 24] = 1.711$.

3. *Work it out.* Margin $1.711 \times 2 = 3.42$. $50 - 3.42 = 46.58$ and $50 + 3.42 = 53.42$.
4. *Result.* CI = (46.58, 53.42).

Answer. 90% CI $(46.58, 53.42)$.

Mock 3 (HW5 style). $\sigma = 4$ known, $n = 64$, $\bar{x} = 51$, $H_0\colon \mu = 50$, two-sided, $\alpha = 0.05$

In plain words. σ is known, so it's a Z test. Count how many standard errors 51 is away from 50 and compare that with 1.96.

1. *Formula.* $Z = \dfrac{\bar{x} - \mu_0}{\sigma/\sqrt{n}}$. *Plug in.* $\dfrac{51 - 50}{4/\sqrt{64}}$. *Work it out.* SE $= 4/8 = 0.5$, $Z = 1/0.5$. *Result.* $Z = 2.0$.
2. $|Z| = 2.0 > 1.96$, reject. *Formula.* $p = 2(1 - \Phi(|Z|))$. *Plug in.* $2(1 - \Phi(2.0)) = 2(1 - 0.9772)$. *Work it out.* 2×0.0228. *Result.* $p = 0.0456$.
3. At $\alpha = 0.01$ (2.576) you'd fail to reject. Report p and the CI $51 \pm 1.96 \times 0.5 = 51 \pm 0.98 = (50.02, 51.98)$, not just the verdict (HT p.16).

Answer. $Z = 2.0$, $p = 0.046$, reject H_0 at 0.05.

Mock 4 (HW6 style). Paired differences 1, 3, 2, 4, 0 on 5 benchmarks. 95% CI on the mean difference

In plain words. The differences are already paired, so this is a one-sample t CI on the differences with $n - 1 = 4$ df. Then check whether 0 is inside.

1. Mean. $\bar{d} = (1 + 3 + 2 + 4 + 0)/5 = 10/5 = 2$.
2. SD. *Formula.* $s_d^2 = \dfrac{\sum(d_i - \bar{d})^2}{n - 1}$. *Plug in.* Deviations $-1, 1, 0, 2, -2$, squares $1, 1, 0, 4, 4$. *Work it out.* $10/4 = 2.5$. *Result.* $s_d = \sqrt{2.5} = 1.581$.
3. SE $= 1.581/\sqrt{5} = 1.581/2.236 = 0.707$.
4. CI. $t[0.025, 4] = 2.776$, margin $2.776 \times 0.707 = 1.963$. $2 - 1.963 = 0.04$ and $2 + 1.963 = 3.96$.

Answer. CI = (0.04, 3.96). It just excludes 0, so a difference is shown. The size is anywhere from almost nothing to about 4, which you should say.